

GHOST NICHE BIBLE

EVOLUTIONARY MISMATCH CHANNEL

The Sub-Niche No One Has Claimed Yet

Ancient Humans + Dark Psychology + Modern Life = Untapped Viral Formula

This document is a full operational Bible for a YouTube channel built around the concept of Evolutionary Mismatch — why your brain is a 300,000-year-old machine trying to survive in a 21st-century world. It contains channel strategy, content architecture, viral video formulas, keyword intelligence, thumbnail doctrine, monetization map, transcript templates, and paste zones for screenshots and assets. Any AI model can read this and execute.

Version 1.0 | Confidential | @dimitri-snowdev

SECTION 1 — NICHE DISCOVERY & REMIX LOGIC

1.1 The Problem: Why Standard Niches Are Saturated

Channels like Zenn (159K subs, +23% in 30 days) have already claimed the 'Ancient Humans' search territory. Keywords like 'what did ancient humans eat', 'prehistoric humans', and 'human evolution' are indexed and dominated. A new channel entering there is invisible for 12-18 months minimum.

Channels like Mindplicit and Dark Psychology Coded have already claimed the 'Dark Psychology' faceless format. The 'Why Modern Life Is Broken' angle is being crowded by Stoicism and self-help channels. Neither niche has a truly unowned remix as of mid-2026.

1.2 The Ghost Niche: Evolutionary Mismatch

Evolutionary Mismatch is the scientific theory that our brains, bodies, and instincts evolved for a Stone Age world — and are now catastrophically misaligned with modern life. Depression, anxiety, loneliness, junk food addiction, phone addiction, burnout, insomnia, comparison culture: all are predictable outputs of ancient software running in the wrong environment.

This concept sits at the exact intersection of three proven viral niches:

- Niche A — Ancient Humans (Zenn model): 'What did ancient humans do?' videos proven at 682K+ views per upload
- Niche B — Dark Psychology / Why Modern Life Is Broken: 21x growth rate in 2026, \$7-15 RPM, betrayal/revenge/dark truth format proven viral
- Niche C — Science Explained for Everyday Life: 16x growth rate, channels like Kurzgesagt (21M subs) and Veritasium (16M subs) prove format viability

The Remix Formula: Take Zenn's ancient-human narrative depth + Dark Psychology's emotional hook ('this is why your life feels wrong') + the 'science explains everything' format = a channel that no one occupies yet at the level of quality required for virality.

1.3 Proof of Concept: The Market Gap

Signal	Evidence
Keyword opportunity	'evolutionary mismatch' has near-zero YouTube coverage but is backed by mainstream science articles, Wikipedia, and a growing academic consensus
Social media search	TikTok/Reels: 'why am I unhappy' + 'we weren't made for this world' content goes millions of views regularly — no dedicated YouTube channel owns this angle

Growth data	Dark psychology + faceless storytelling: 21x growth rate (OutlierKit 2026). Science explained humorously: 16x growth. Both overlap with this niche.
RPM potential	Education + Psychology = \$7-15 RPM. Wellness/Health angle = \$7-20 RPM. Combined audience: premium.
Competitor vacuum	No channel with 100K+ subs is currently doing Evolutionary Mismatch as its primary identity — confirmed via vidIQ search on June 2026
Cross-platform fit	Evolutionary mismatch content maps perfectly to Shorts ('Your phone is exploiting your tribal brain'), Reels, and TikTok — multi-platform distribution from day 1

SECTION 2 — CHANNEL IDENTITY & BRAND

2.1 Channel Concept in One Sentence

You are a 300,000-year-old hunter-gatherer living in 2026 — and that is why everything hurts.

This channel explains every modern human struggle through the lens of evolutionary mismatch: your biology is ancient, your environment is not. Every video answers one question the viewer already has about their own life, then shows them the science that was always hiding underneath it.

2.2 Channel Name Options

The channel name must be brandable, searchable, and feel cinematic. Options:

Name Option	Why It Works
MisWired	Short, memorable, implies 'wrong wiring for modern world' — can own the keyword
Paleo Mind	Immediately signals ancient brain + modern contrast, searchable
The Ancestral Brain	Authoritative, documentary-feel, SEO clear
Stone Age Brain	High search signal, direct, Zenn-adjacent without being Zenn
Evolved Wrong	Provocative, dark psychology tone, emotional hook
Ancient Signal	Poetic, cinematic, works across formats

Recommendation: MisWired or Stone Age Brain. Both are currently unclaimed as YouTube channel identities.

2.3 Visual Identity

- Primary color: Deep navy (#1A1A2E) — serious, documentary, premium
- Accent: Coral-red (#E94560) — emotional urgency, dark psychology feel
- Secondary: Warm gold (#C9A84C) — ancient/archaeological tone
- Font: Bold sans-serif for titles (Montserrat / Bebas Neue), clean serif for body on thumbnails
- Aesthetic: Cinematic split — half Stone Age cave painting texture, half neon city lights. The visual metaphor IS the niche.

2.4 Channel Tagline Options

- 'Your brain was built for a world that no longer exists.'
- 'Ancient instincts. Modern consequences.'
- 'Science explains why modern life feels wrong.'

- 'You are not broken. You are just mismatched.'
 - 'The prehistoric mind in a hypermodern world.'
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2.5 Channel Description Template

You are a 300,000-year-old creature living in 2026. Your brain craves sugar because your ancestors needed calories. Your phone hijacks your tribal instincts. Your anxiety is a predator-detection system with nothing to detect. Your loneliness is a savanna alarm in a city of millions. Every week, we use evolutionary science, anthropology, and psychology to explain why modern life feels wrong — and what the archaeological record says about how humans were actually designed to live. No self-help. No hacks. Just the science that was always hiding underneath your daily struggles.

SECTION 3 — CONTENT ARCHITECTURE

3.1 The Three Content Pillars

Every video belongs to one of three pillars. Pillar 1 is the core viral engine. Pillars 2 and 3 expand the audience and sustain retention.

PILLAR	THEME	EXAMPLE TITLES
PILLAR 1(Core Engine)	Modern Problem Explained by Ancient Biology	'Why You Can't Stop Scrolling (Your Brain Is Hunting)'"Why Modern People Are So Lonely'"Your Anxiety Is Not a Disorder. It's Ancient Software.'
PILLAR 2(Anchor Series)	How Ancient Humans Actually Lived (Zenn-adjacent but differentiated)	'What an Ancient Human's Day Actually Felt Like'"Why Hunter-Gatherers Never Got Burnout'"The Tribe Rule That Kept Everyone Sane'
PILLAR 3(Dark Hook)	The Dark Side of Human Nature (Evolution's Uncomfortable Truths)	'Why Humans Are Naturally Violent (And What Stops Them)'"The Evolutionary Reason We Envy Our Friends'"Why We Evolved to Fear Being Alone More Than Death'

3.2 Video Format Specification

- Length: 7-12 minutes (matches Zenn's proven 8-10 min sweet spot for this niche)
- Style: Cinematic narration-only (no face). Stock footage + motion graphics + minimal text overlays
- Voice: Calm, measured, authoritative. Slight gravity. NOT hype, NOT self-help motivational.
- Structure: Hook (0-30s) → Science Setup (30s-2min) → Mismatch Reveal (2-6min) → Modern Implication (6-10min) → Resonant Close (10-12min)
- Sourcing: Peer-reviewed papers cited in description (mimics Zenn's trust-building approach)
- Shorts: Create 45-60s vertical versions of the hook section from every long-form video

3.3 12-Month Content Calendar Skeleton

Month 1-2: PILLAR 1 launch — establish the mismatch concept with mass-appeal hooks

- Ep 1: 'Why You Can't Stop Scrolling (Your Brain Is Still Hunting)'
- Ep 2: 'The Real Reason Modern People Are So Lonely'
- Ep 3: 'Your Anxiety Is Not a Disorder. It's Ancient Software.'
- Ep 4: 'Why Humans Were Never Meant to Work 8 Hours a Day'

Month 3-4: Introduce PILLAR 2 series — establish authority in ancient-human territory

- Ep 5: 'What an Ancient Human's Morning Actually Felt Like'

- Ep 6: 'Why Hunter-Gatherers Were Happier Than You'
- Ep 7: 'The Tribe Rule That Kept Ancient Humans Mentally Healthy'

Month 5-6: Introduce PILLAR 3 — push the dark angle to expand audience

- Ep 8: 'Why Humans Evolved to Gossip (And What That Does to Your Brain)'
- Ep 9: 'The Evolutionary Reason We Envy Our Friends'
- Ep 10: 'Why We Evolved to Fear Being Alone More Than Death'

Month 7-12: Build trilogies, cross-link videos, capitalize on growing subscriber base with deeper dives

SECTION 4 — THE VIRAL VIDEO FORMULA

4.1 Title Formula

Every viral title in this niche follows one of three structures:

Structure A — Modern Problem as Archaeological Fact

- Pattern: 'The Real Reason [Modern Problem]'
- Examples: 'The Real Reason You're Always Tired' / 'The Real Reason Friendships Feel Hollow'
- Why it works: frames a personal pain as scientific fact — viewer feels seen + curious

Structure B — Ancient Biology Causing Modern Chaos

- Pattern: 'Your Brain [does X] Because [ancient context]'
- Examples: 'Your Brain Is Still Scanning for Predators (That's Your Anxiety)' / 'Your Brain Treats Social Media Like a Savanna'
- Why it works: immediate identity hook + counterintuitive reframe

Structure C — Provocation + Science Proof

- Pattern: '[Bold Claim]. Science Proved It.'
- Examples: 'Modern Humans Are the First Humans to Feel Truly Alone. Science Proved It.' / 'You Were Never Built to Sit Still. Science Proved It.'
- Why it works: mirrors Zenn's best performer 'You're Dumber Than Your Grandparents (Science Proved It)'

4.2 Hook Formula (First 30 Seconds)

The hook must accomplish three things in under 30 seconds: create an identity statement, introduce tension, and promise resolution. Template:

[OPENING FACT — something the viewer feels daily, stated as a clinical observation]e.g. 'Right now, somewhere between 4 and 8 percent of your working memory is occupied by a background hum of social anxiety. You probably call it stress. You may call it overthinking. Scientists call it something very different.' [REFRAME — introduce the evolutionary lens in one sentence]e.g. 'That hum is a 300,000-year-old predator detection system that has nothing left to detect.' [PROMISE — what the viewer will understand by the end]e.g. 'This video is about why your anxiety is not a malfunction. It is an ancient signal. And once you understand what it was designed for, the way you live with it changes completely.'

4.3 Full Script Architecture (Beat Sheet)

Beat	Content
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HOOK [0:00–0:30]	Open on the modern pain. State it clinically. Reframe it as evolutionary signal. Promise the answer.
SETUP THE SCIENCE [0:30–2:00]	Introduce the key evolutionary concept (mismatch theory, ancestral environment, the specific instinct). Cite one real study. Make it visual through narration.
THE ANCIENT WORLD [2:00–4:00]	Drop into the Stone Age. Describe what this behavior/instinct was actually FOR. How it helped our ancestors survive. Be specific and cinematic — describe the savanna, the tribe, the hunt.
THE JUMP TO NOW [4:00–6:00]	The mismatch reveal. Show exactly how the ancient mechanism gets hijacked in modern context. This is the core insight. Give multiple examples from everyday life.
THE DARK IMPLICATION [6:00–8:30]	Explore the uncomfortable truth. What does this mean about modern society? Be willing to say something most people won't. This is where engagement spikes.
THE EVIDENCE [8:30–10:00]	Bring in a second study, a statistic, an expert quote. Deepen the credibility. Reference a real tribe or archaeological finding.
THE RESONANT CLOSE [10:00–END]	Don't give a 5-step solution. Give one reframe. Leave the viewer sitting with a new way of seeing their life. End on something cinematic and slightly haunting.

4.4 The 'Never Do' List

- Never end with 'Like and Subscribe' as the first closing line — it breaks immersion
- Never give a listicle ('Here are 7 ways to...') — this is NOT a self-help channel
- Never use upbeat, motivational music — this is a documentary, not a hustle vlog
- Never be on camera — the faceless format is a feature, not a limitation
- Never use clickbait that the video can't deliver — the viewer must finish feeling the title was EXACTLY right

SECTION 5 — KEYWORD & SEO INTELLIGENCE

5.1 Primary Keyword Targets (from real vidIQ data, June 2026)

Keyword	Volume Score	Competition	Monthly Searches	Priority
prehistoric humans	77	41	154,825	HIGH
what did ancient humans eat	76	45	135,451	HIGH
human evolution	82	51	307,775	MEDIUM
hunter gatherer lifestyle	62	21	15,259	VERY HIGH
anthropology documentary	64	26	18,743	VERY HIGH
ancient cannibalism	55	23	4,644	VERY HIGH
food addiction science	62	41	15,542	HIGH
why modern life is unhappy	—	LOW	rising	VERY HIGH
evolutionary mismatch	—	VERY LOW	emerging	FIRST-MOVER
hunter gatherer happiness	—	VERY LOW	emerging	FIRST-MOVER
ancestral health mental	—	VERY LOW	emerging	FIRST-MOVER

FIRST-MOVER keywords (evolutionary mismatch, hunter gatherer happiness, ancestral health mental) have near-zero YouTube coverage. Videos published now become the definitive reference for those terms as search volume grows. This is the same position Zenn was in 6 months before their breakout.

5.2 Tag Bank for Videos

Use these tags on every video (adapt to specific topic):

- evolutionary mismatch, ancestral brain, hunter gatherer modern life, ancient instincts, why modern life is hard
- evolutionary psychology, prehistoric humans, anthropology, human evolution, stone age brain
- why are humans unhappy, modern loneliness, anxiety explained, burnout science, screen addiction brain
- ancestral health, paleo mind, mismatch theory, ancient humans psychology, tribal instincts

5.3 Description Template (for every video)

[OPENING HOOK — 2-3 sentences that restate the video's core provocative insight. Should make someone want to watch even without context.] This video explores [CORE MISMATCH TOPIC] — why your [MODERN BEHAVIOR/FEELING] is actually a [ANCIENT MECHANISM] that evolved to [ORIGINAL PURPOSE] in a world that no longer exists. _____WATCH
NEXT _____[Link Video 1][Link Video
2] _____SOURCES _____
_____[Study 1 — Author, Year, Journal, DOI][Study 2 — Author, Year, Journal,
DOI]#evolutionarymismatch #ancienthumans #humanevolution #anthropology
#psychology

SECTION 6 — THUMBNAIL DOCTRINE

6.1 Thumbnail Formula

Zenn's thumbnails use: dark/cinematic background + bold white text overlay + no human face. This works because it signals 'documentary' not 'vlog'. For this channel, the formula is the same but with a deliberate split visual:

- LEFT SIDE: Ancient / prehistoric imagery (cave, stone tools, fire, savanna, tribe silhouette)
 - RIGHT SIDE: Modern equivalent (phone screen, city skyline, office cubicle, social media notification)
 - Text overlay: The provocative question or statement, in bold white or gold, centered or along the bottom
 - Color grade: The ancient side is warm/sepia, the modern side is cool/neon — the split is the message
 - NO face needed — the visual contrast IS the hook
-

6.2 Thumbnail Text Rules

- Maximum 6 words on the thumbnail
 - Must create a knowledge gap ('Why You Can't Stop' — stop WHAT? viewer must click)
 - Avoid question marks — statements are stronger ('Your Brain Is Still Hunting' > 'Is Your Brain Still Hunting?')
 - Use one accent color word in gold or red to draw the eye
-

6.3 Thumbnail Reference: Zenn's Top Performers

Paste screenshots of Zenn's best-performing thumbnails below for reference. Analyze: what text, what background, what visual structure makes each one click-worthy.

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

THUMBNAIL SCREENSHOT — 'What Did Ancient Humans Actually Eat?' (682K views) Paste screenshot here. Note: background tone, text size, text position, color contrast, visual element used.



[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

THUMBNAIL SCREENSHOT — 'What Did Ancient Humans Do All Day?' (323K views) Paste screenshot here. Compare text weight and positioning vs the previous thumbnail.



[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

THUMBNAIL SCREENSHOT — 'Why Hasn't Anyone Raised the Titanic?' (167K views) Paste screenshot here. Note how they handle a more mainstream topic visually.



[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

YOUR CHANNEL — Thumbnail Mockup (Hand-drawn or AI-generated draft) Paste your own thumbnail concept here. Label: which video is it for? What split visual are you using? What is the text?

SECTION 7 — VIRAL VIDEO DEEP DIVES

(Reference Analysis)

This section holds detailed analysis of competitor viral videos for reference and reverse-engineering. Paste screenshots, transcripts, and performance data for each.

7.1 Zenn — 'What Did Ancient Humans Actually Eat?' (682K views)

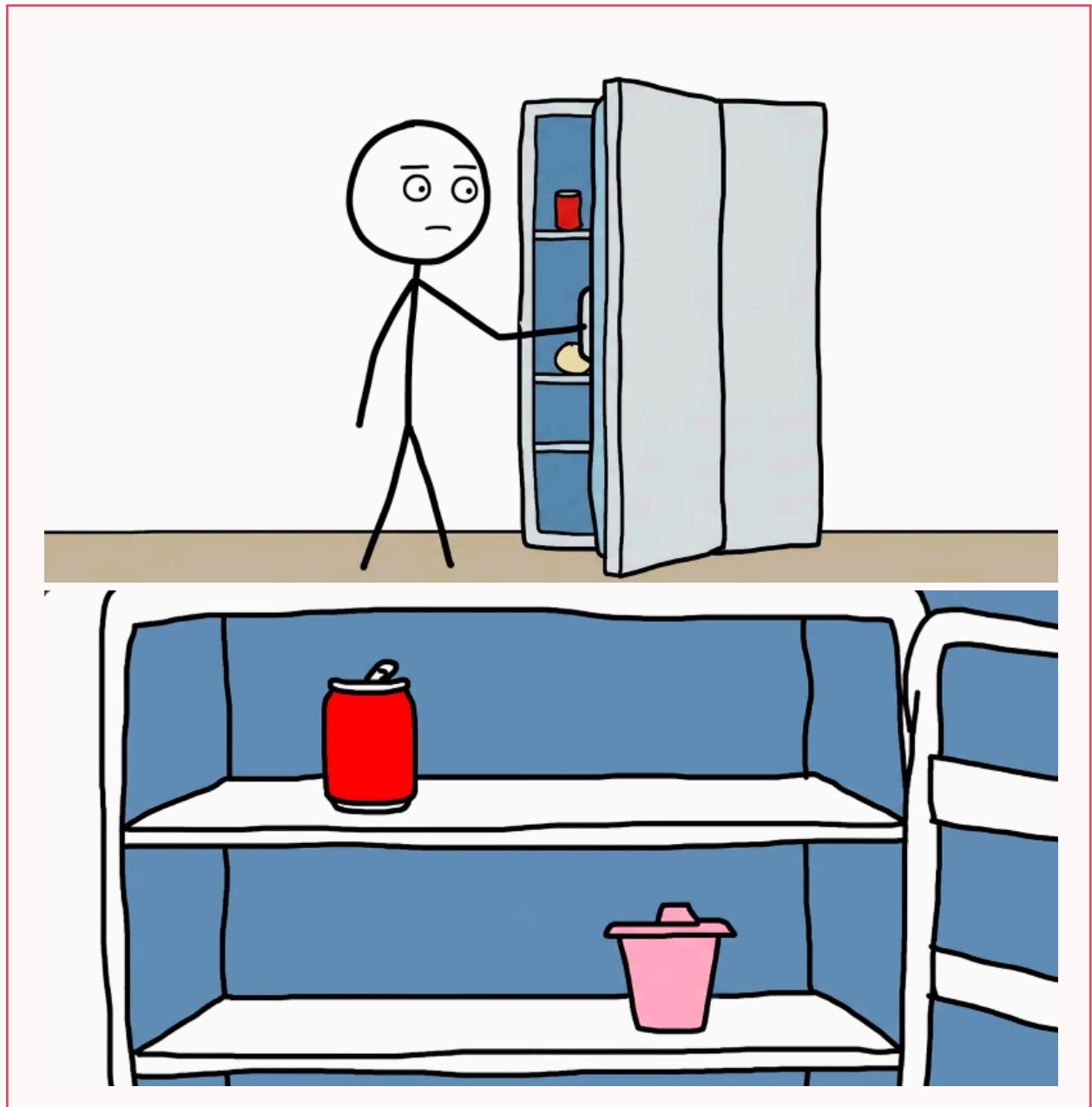
Performance Data

Metric	Value
Views (as of June 2026)	682,500
Likes	14,957
Comments	839
Like-to-view ratio	~2.2% (strong)
Peak VPH (views per hour)	~2,800 at Day 5
Days to first 100K views	~5 days
Velocity pattern	Sustained organic — NOT a one-time spike. Still generating 30-70 VPH at 60+ days
Published	April 24, 2026

Screenshot Zone

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

VIDEO SCREENSHOT — In-video still from 'Ancient Humans Eat'Paste a frame from the video (e.g. the opening shot, a compelling visual, or the most-shared moment).



Transcript Sample — Paste With Timestamps

Paste the video transcript below, with timestamps, for full script analysis. Format: [MM:SS]
dialogue

1
00:00:00,160 --> 00:00:01,910
Open your fridge right now. A can of

2

00:00:01,910 --> 00:00:01,920

3

00:00:01,920 --> 00:00:04,390

soda, some yogurt, leftover pizza, and

4

00:00:04,390 --> 00:00:04,400

5

00:00:04,400 --> 00:00:05,990

maybe some fruit flown in from the other

6

00:00:05,990 --> 00:00:06,000

7

00:00:06,000 --> 00:00:07,190

side of the planet. But to your

8

00:00:07,190 --> 00:00:07,200

9

00:00:07,200 --> 00:00:09,350

ancestors, none of this is food. So,

10

00:00:09,350 --> 00:00:09,360

11

00:00:09,360 --> 00:00:11,270

what did they actually eat? The answer

12

00:00:11,270 --> 00:00:11,280

13

00:00:11,280 --> 00:00:13,589

would horrify most people alive today.

14

00:00:13,589 --> 00:00:13,599

15

00:00:13,599 --> 00:00:15,350

Scientists have found proof in caves

16

00:00:15,350 --> 00:00:15,360

17

00:00:15,360 --> 00:00:17,269

around the world. Proof that changes

18

00:00:17,269 --> 00:00:17,279

19

00:00:17,279 --> 00:00:19,029

everything we thought we knew about our

20

00:00:19,029 --> 00:00:19,039

21

00:00:19,039 --> 00:00:21,269

own species. But to understand it, we

22

00:00:21,269 --> 00:00:21,279

23

00:00:21,279 --> 00:00:22,550

have to go back to the beginning,

24

00:00:22,550 --> 00:00:22,560

25

00:00:22,560 --> 00:00:24,550
roughly 3 million years ago. Your

26

00:00:24,550 --> 00:00:24,560

27

00:00:24,560 --> 00:00:26,630
earliest ancestors were not hunters.

28

00:00:26,630 --> 00:00:26,640

29

00:00:26,640 --> 00:00:28,630
They were scavengers. When a lion killed

30

00:00:28,630 --> 00:00:28,640

31

00:00:28,640 --> 00:00:30,710
an antelope on the African savannah, it

32

00:00:30,710 --> 00:00:30,720

33

00:00:30,720 --> 00:00:33,030
ate the best parts first. The muscle,

34

00:00:33,030 --> 00:00:33,040

35

00:00:33,040 --> 00:00:35,430
the liver, the heart. Then the hyenas

36

00:00:35,430 --> 00:00:35,440

37

00:00:35,440 --> 00:00:37,190

came in for the rest, and they crunched

38

00:00:37,190 --> 00:00:37,200

39

00:00:37,200 --> 00:00:39,110

through the ribs, the skin, and the

40

00:00:39,110 --> 00:00:39,120

41

00:00:39,120 --> 00:00:41,270

smaller bones. By the time our ancestors

42

00:00:41,270 --> 00:00:41,280

43

00:00:41,280 --> 00:00:43,350

got there, what was left was scraps,

44

00:00:43,350 --> 00:00:43,360

45

00:00:43,360 --> 00:00:45,750

thick leg bones, bones too thick even

46

00:00:45,750 --> 00:00:45,760

47

00:00:45,760 --> 00:00:47,990

for hyena jaws to break. And this is

48

00:00:47,990 --> 00:00:48,000

49

00:00:48,000 --> 00:00:49,990

what our ancestors ate. Their signature

50

00:00:49,990 --> 00:00:50,000

51

00:00:50,000 --> 00:00:52,229

meal was bone marrow. Early humans would

52

00:00:52,229 --> 00:00:52,239

53

00:00:52,239 --> 00:00:54,549

creep up to a stripped carcass, grab the

54

00:00:54,549 --> 00:00:54,559

55

00:00:54,559 --> 00:00:56,470

thickest leg bones, and smash them open

56

00:00:56,470 --> 00:00:56,480

57

00:00:56,480 --> 00:00:59,029

with stone flakes called oldan tools.

58

00:00:59,029 --> 00:00:59,039

59

00:00:59,039 --> 00:01:01,910

Inside was marrow, gray, slick, dripping

60

00:01:01,910 --> 00:01:01,920

61

00:01:01,920 --> 00:01:03,430

fat. They scooped it out with their

62

00:01:03,430 --> 00:01:03,440

63

00:01:03,440 --> 00:01:05,350

fingers and ate it raw. For our

64

00:01:05,350 --> 00:01:05,360

65

00:01:05,360 --> 00:01:07,510

ancestors, this was a feast. No other

66

00:01:07,510 --> 00:01:07,520

67

00:01:07,520 --> 00:01:09,109

animal could get at it. The marrow was

68

00:01:09,109 --> 00:01:09,119

69

00:01:09,119 --> 00:01:11,190

sealed inside thick thigh bones, and we

70

00:01:11,190 --> 00:01:11,200

71

00:01:11,200 --> 00:01:12,950

had the one thing no other scavenger

72

00:01:12,950 --> 00:01:12,960

73

00:01:12,960 --> 00:01:14,710

had. Hands that could grip a rock hard

74

00:01:14,710 --> 00:01:14,720

75

00:01:14,720 --> 00:01:16,230

enough to break them open. They ate the

76

00:01:16,230 --> 00:01:16,240

77

00:01:16,240 --> 00:01:18,070

brains, too. A cracked skull holds

78

00:01:18,070 --> 00:01:18,080

79

00:01:18,080 --> 00:01:20,230

almost a pound of solid fat, and fat is

80

00:01:20,230 --> 00:01:20,240

81

00:01:20,240 --> 00:01:21,990

the most calorie dense food in the

82

00:01:21,990 --> 00:01:22,000

83

00:01:22,000 --> 00:01:23,749
animal. For an ancestor living on

84

00:01:23,749 --> 00:01:23,759

85

00:01:23,759 --> 00:01:26,390
scraps, a skull was a jackpot. This is

86

00:01:26,390 --> 00:01:26,400

87

00:01:26,400 --> 00:01:28,070
why your body still treats fat like

88

00:01:28,070 --> 00:01:28,080

89

00:01:28,080 --> 00:01:30,070
treasure. It still remembers. We also

90

00:01:30,070 --> 00:01:30,080

91

00:01:30,080 --> 00:01:33,030
ate insects, termites, grubs, beetles,

92

00:01:33,030 --> 00:01:33,040

93

00:01:33,040 --> 00:01:34,870
fat white larvy the size of your thumb.

94

00:01:34,870 --> 00:01:34,880

95

00:01:34,880 --> 00:01:36,550

They crunched like shrimp. For your deep

96

00:01:36,550 --> 00:01:36,560

97

00:01:36,560 --> 00:01:38,630

ancestors, insects were not a last

98

00:01:38,630 --> 00:01:38,640

99

00:01:38,640 --> 00:01:40,710

resort. They were dinner. This was life

100

00:01:40,710 --> 00:01:40,720

101

00:01:40,720 --> 00:01:43,109

for over a million years, day after day,

102

00:01:43,109 --> 00:01:43,119

103

00:01:43,119 --> 00:01:45,030

generation after generation. But what

104

00:01:45,030 --> 00:01:45,040

105

00:01:45,040 --> 00:01:46,469

came later is worse than you can

106

00:01:46,469 --> 00:01:46,479

107

00:01:46,479 --> 00:01:49,030

imagine. First fire. The oldest human

108

00:01:49,030 --> 00:01:49,040

109

00:01:49,040 --> 00:01:50,870

fire we have ever found is inside

110

00:01:50,870 --> 00:01:50,880

111

00:01:50,880 --> 00:01:53,030

Wonderwork Cave in South Africa. It is

112

00:01:53,030 --> 00:01:53,040

113

00:01:53,040 --> 00:01:55,030

about a million years old. Once we had

114

00:01:55,030 --> 00:01:55,040

115

00:01:55,040 --> 00:01:57,350

fire, we had cooking. Meat roasted over

116

00:01:57,350 --> 00:01:57,360

117

00:01:57,360 --> 00:02:00,230

coals, roots buried in hot ashes, marrow

118

00:02:00,230 --> 00:02:00,240

119

00:02:00,240 --> 00:02:02,310

bones dropped in the embers. Cooking is

120

00:02:02,310 --> 00:02:02,320

121

00:02:02,320 --> 00:02:05,190

predigestion. Raw meat and raw plants

122

00:02:05,190 --> 00:02:05,200

123

00:02:05,200 --> 00:02:07,270

force your gut to do hours of chemical

124

00:02:07,270 --> 00:02:07,280

125

00:02:07,280 --> 00:02:09,350

work to break them down. Cooked food is

126

00:02:09,350 --> 00:02:09,360

127

00:02:09,360 --> 00:02:11,350

already partly broken apart. Your body

128

00:02:11,350 --> 00:02:11,360

129

00:02:11,360 --> 00:02:13,190
spends less energy digesting it and

130

00:02:13,190 --> 00:02:13,200

131

00:02:13,200 --> 00:02:14,949
pulls more calories out of every bite.

132

00:02:14,949 --> 00:02:14,959

133

00:02:14,959 --> 00:02:16,550
And scientists believe that as our

134

00:02:16,550 --> 00:02:16,560

135

00:02:16,560 --> 00:02:18,869
ancestors started cooking, their guts

136

00:02:18,869 --> 00:02:18,879

137

00:02:18,879 --> 00:02:21,030
shrank. That freed up huge amounts of

138

00:02:21,030 --> 00:02:21,040

139

00:02:21,040 --> 00:02:23,190
energy and it all went to one place, the

140

00:02:23,190 --> 00:02:23,200

141

00:02:23,200 --> 00:02:25,190

brain. It is only 2% of your body

142

00:02:25,190 --> 00:02:25,200

143

00:02:25,200 --> 00:02:27,430

weight, but uses 20% of your body's

144

00:02:27,430 --> 00:02:27,440

145

00:02:27,440 --> 00:02:29,750

calories. You cannot run that machine on

146

00:02:29,750 --> 00:02:29,760

147

00:02:29,760 --> 00:02:32,630

raw leaves and termites. You need cooked

148

00:02:32,630 --> 00:02:32,640

149

00:02:32,640 --> 00:02:34,949

fatrich food. Cooking gave us our

150

00:02:34,949 --> 00:02:34,959

151

00:02:34,959 --> 00:02:36,630

brains, and our brains gave us

152

00:02:36,630 --> 00:02:36,640

153

00:02:36,640 --> 00:02:38,790

everything else. That's when the menu

154

00:02:38,790 --> 00:02:38,800

155

00:02:38,800 --> 00:02:41,350

exploded. By 300,000 years ago, your

156

00:02:41,350 --> 00:02:41,360

157

00:02:41,360 --> 00:02:43,589

ancestors looked much like you do today.

158

00:02:43,589 --> 00:02:43,599

159

00:02:43,599 --> 00:02:44,949

And they were eating almost everything

160

00:02:44,949 --> 00:02:44,959

161

00:02:44,959 --> 00:02:47,270

they could catch, dig up, or reach.

162

00:02:47,270 --> 00:02:47,280

163

00:02:47,280 --> 00:02:50,229

Mammoth, bison, wild horse, and reindeer

164

00:02:50,229 --> 00:02:50,239

165

00:02:50,239 --> 00:02:52,309

on the plains, fish, and shellfish from

166

00:02:52,309 --> 00:02:52,319

167

00:02:52,319 --> 00:02:54,550

the rivers and coasts, roots, wild

168

00:02:54,550 --> 00:02:54,560

169

00:02:54,560 --> 00:02:57,030

grains, berries, nuts, and mushrooms

170

00:02:57,030 --> 00:02:57,040

171

00:02:57,040 --> 00:02:59,430

from the land itself, eggs stolen from

172

00:02:59,430 --> 00:02:59,440

173

00:02:59,440 --> 00:03:02,390

nests, and honey, especially honey. The

174

00:03:02,390 --> 00:03:02,400

175

00:03:02,400 --> 00:03:04,149

Hodza, a huntergatherer tribe in

176

00:03:04,149 --> 00:03:04,159

177

00:03:04,159 --> 00:03:06,550

Tanzania, still eat the way humans ate

178

00:03:06,550 --> 00:03:06,560

179

00:03:06,560 --> 00:03:09,110

before farming existed. About 15% of

180

00:03:09,110 --> 00:03:09,120

181

00:03:09,120 --> 00:03:10,869

their calories come from wild honey.

182

00:03:10,869 --> 00:03:10,879

183

00:03:10,879 --> 00:03:13,190

They climb dangerous trees, get stung

184

00:03:13,190 --> 00:03:13,200

185

00:03:13,200 --> 00:03:15,110

hundreds of times, and keep going back

186

00:03:15,110 --> 00:03:15,120

187

00:03:15,120 --> 00:03:16,949

because nothing else in the wild packs

188

00:03:16,949 --> 00:03:16,959

189

00:03:16,959 --> 00:03:19,190

that many calories into one bite. And

190

00:03:19,190 --> 00:03:19,200

191

00:03:19,200 --> 00:03:21,190

here's what's strange. That exact same

192

00:03:21,190 --> 00:03:21,200

193

00:03:21,200 --> 00:03:23,509

craving is still alive in you today.

194

00:03:23,509 --> 00:03:23,519

195

00:03:23,519 --> 00:03:25,350

Sugar. Your brain is wired for it

196

00:03:25,350 --> 00:03:25,360

197

00:03:25,360 --> 00:03:26,869

because for hundreds of thousands of

198

00:03:26,869 --> 00:03:26,879

199

00:03:26,879 --> 00:03:29,190

years, sugar gave your body two things

200

00:03:29,190 --> 00:03:29,200

201

00:03:29,200 --> 00:03:31,750

at once. Instant energy to use right now

202

00:03:31,750 --> 00:03:31,760

203

00:03:31,760 --> 00:03:34,630

and extra fuel your body stored as fat.

204

00:03:34,630 --> 00:03:34,640

205

00:03:34,640 --> 00:03:36,229

That fat was the only thing that kept

206

00:03:36,229 --> 00:03:36,239

207

00:03:36,239 --> 00:03:38,390

you alive when food ran out. A dripping

208

00:03:38,390 --> 00:03:38,400

209

00:03:38,400 --> 00:03:40,390

honeycomb was the richest meal most of

210

00:03:40,390 --> 00:03:40,400

211

00:03:40,400 --> 00:03:42,550

your ancestors ever laid eyes on. This

212

00:03:42,550 --> 00:03:42,560

213

00:03:42,560 --> 00:03:44,229

is the program running inside you right

214

00:03:44,229 --> 00:03:44,239

215

00:03:44,239 --> 00:03:45,750

now. Your body cannot tell the

216

00:03:45,750 --> 00:03:45,760

217

00:03:45,760 --> 00:03:47,350

difference between honey in a tree and a

218

00:03:47,350 --> 00:03:47,360

219

00:03:47,360 --> 00:03:49,350

donut. Modern food took that ancient

220

00:03:49,350 --> 00:03:49,360

221

00:03:49,360 --> 00:03:51,190

signal and turned it into a business.

222

00:03:51,190 --> 00:03:51,200

223

00:03:51,200 --> 00:03:54,630

Soda, candy, cereal, sauces, even most

224

00:03:54,630 --> 00:03:54,640

225

00:03:54,640 --> 00:03:56,550

bread. Almost every packaged food on

226

00:03:56,550 --> 00:03:56,560

227

00:03:56,560 --> 00:03:58,070

Earth is sugar wearing a different

228

00:03:58,070 --> 00:03:58,080

229

00:03:58,080 --> 00:04:00,149

costume. That is why you cannot stop

230

00:04:00,149 --> 00:04:00,159

231

00:04:00,159 --> 00:04:01,910

eating it. Your body is still trying to

232

00:04:01,910 --> 00:04:01,920

233

00:04:01,920 --> 00:04:03,670

store fat for the next time food runs

234

00:04:03,670 --> 00:04:03,680

235

00:04:03,680 --> 00:04:05,670

out. But sugar wasn't the only thing

236

00:04:05,670 --> 00:04:05,680

237

00:04:05,680 --> 00:04:08,070

your body got hooked on. So, what else

238

00:04:08,070 --> 00:04:08,080

239

00:04:08,080 --> 00:04:10,550

did your ancestors learn to crave? Meat.

240

00:04:10,550 --> 00:04:10,560

241

00:04:10,560 --> 00:04:12,630

A single mammoth carcass could feed a

242

00:04:12,630 --> 00:04:12,640

243

00:04:12,640 --> 00:04:14,949

tribe for weeks. One big kill saved

244

00:04:14,949 --> 00:04:14,959

245

00:04:14,959 --> 00:04:16,390

hundreds of hours that would otherwise

246

00:04:16,390 --> 00:04:16,400

247

00:04:16,400 --> 00:04:17,749

have been spent picking berries, and

248

00:04:17,749 --> 00:04:17,759

249

00:04:17,759 --> 00:04:20,229

digging roots. That saved time became

250

00:04:20,229 --> 00:04:20,239

251

00:04:20,239 --> 00:04:22,629

time to raise children, teach skills,

252

00:04:22,629 --> 00:04:22,639

253

00:04:22,639 --> 00:04:24,629

make better tools, tell stories around

254

00:04:24,629 --> 00:04:24,639

255

00:04:24,639 --> 00:04:26,550

fires. This is why your body still

256

00:04:26,550 --> 00:04:26,560

257

00:04:26,560 --> 00:04:28,710

craves protein. Every craving you have

258

00:04:28,710 --> 00:04:28,720

259

00:04:28,720 --> 00:04:30,469

today was shaped by what kept them

260

00:04:30,469 --> 00:04:30,479

261

00:04:30,479 --> 00:04:32,629

alive. But there was one craving we

262

00:04:32,629 --> 00:04:32,639

263

00:04:32,639 --> 00:04:35,590

still have trouble admitting each other.

264

00:04:35,590 --> 00:04:35,600

265

00:04:35,600 --> 00:04:38,390

In a cave in England called Guff's Cave,

266

00:04:38,390 --> 00:04:38,400

267

00:04:38,400 --> 00:04:40,790

researchers found human bones from about

268

00:04:40,790 --> 00:04:40,800

269

00:04:40,800 --> 00:04:42,390

14,700

270

00:04:42,390 --> 00:04:42,400

271

00:04:42,400 --> 00:04:44,790

years ago, and the bones told a story no

272

00:04:44,790 --> 00:04:44,800

273

00:04:44,800 --> 00:04:46,870

one wanted to read. The skulls had been

274

00:04:46,870 --> 00:04:46,880

275

00:04:46,880 --> 00:04:49,270

meticulously cleaned with stone tools.

276

00:04:49,270 --> 00:04:49,280

277

00:04:49,280 --> 00:04:51,189

The face and the base had been carefully

278

00:04:51,189 --> 00:04:51,199

279

00:04:51,199 --> 00:04:53,189

removed. What was left was the top of

280

00:04:53,189 --> 00:04:53,199

281

00:04:53,199 --> 00:04:56,230

the skull, shaped rim by rim into a cup.

282

00:04:56,230 --> 00:04:56,240

283

00:04:56,240 --> 00:04:58,469

The long bones had been cracked open the

284

00:04:58,469 --> 00:04:58,479

285

00:04:58,479 --> 00:05:00,870

same way your earliest ancestors cracked

286

00:05:00,870 --> 00:05:00,880

287

00:05:00,880 --> 00:05:03,670

open antelope bones for the marrow. And

288

00:05:03,670 --> 00:05:03,680

289

00:05:03,680 --> 00:05:05,749

here is where it gets worse. This wasn't

290

00:05:05,749 --> 00:05:05,759

291

00:05:05,759 --> 00:05:07,909

starvation. The same cave contains the

292

00:05:07,909 --> 00:05:07,919

293

00:05:07,919 --> 00:05:09,909

remains of horses, deer, and other

294

00:05:09,909 --> 00:05:09,919

295

00:05:09,919 --> 00:05:13,270

animals. There was plenty to eat. A 2017

296

00:05:13,270 --> 00:05:13,280

297

00:05:13,280 --> 00:05:15,670

study calculated how many calories a

298

00:05:15,670 --> 00:05:15,680

299

00:05:15,680 --> 00:05:18,070

human body actually provides. The answer

300

00:05:18,070 --> 00:05:18,080

301

00:05:18,080 --> 00:05:22,550

is around 125,000. A single bison holds

302

00:05:22,550 --> 00:05:22,560

303

00:05:22,560 --> 00:05:25,990

600,000. A mammoth 3 million. Humans

304

00:05:25,990 --> 00:05:26,000

305

00:05:26,000 --> 00:05:28,230

weren't efficient food. They were a

306

00:05:28,230 --> 00:05:28,240

307

00:05:28,240 --> 00:05:30,950

choice. One forearm bone found at Guff's

308

00:05:30,950 --> 00:05:30,960

309

00:05:30,960 --> 00:05:33,270

cave was carved with a zigzag pattern

310

00:05:33,270 --> 00:05:33,280

311

00:05:33,280 --> 00:05:35,510

after the meat was gone. This wasn't a

312

00:05:35,510 --> 00:05:35,520

313

00:05:35,520 --> 00:05:38,230

last resort. This was a ritual. And

314

00:05:38,230 --> 00:05:38,240

315

00:05:38,240 --> 00:05:40,629

Guff's cave isn't the only site. Similar

316

00:05:40,629 --> 00:05:40,639

317

00:05:40,639 --> 00:05:42,310

remains have been found across Europe at

318

00:05:42,310 --> 00:05:42,320

319

00:05:42,320 --> 00:05:45,270

sites in Germany, France, Spain, and

320

00:05:45,270 --> 00:05:45,280

321

00:05:45,280 --> 00:05:47,189

Croatia. For hundreds of thousands of

322

00:05:47,189 --> 00:05:47,199

323

00:05:47,199 --> 00:05:49,189

years in different parts of the world,

324

00:05:49,189 --> 00:05:49,199

325

00:05:49,199 --> 00:05:51,029

humans were doing this to each other.

326

00:05:51,029 --> 00:05:51,039

327

00:05:51,039 --> 00:05:53,270

Not always to survive. Because somewhere

328

00:05:53,270 --> 00:05:53,280

329

00:05:53,280 --> 00:05:55,189

in our history, we decided it meant

330

00:05:55,189 --> 00:05:55,199

331

00:05:55,199 --> 00:05:57,110

something. And it gets stranger. Your

332

00:05:57,110 --> 00:05:57,120

333

00:05:57,120 --> 00:05:59,350

ancestors didn't just eat fresh meat.

334

00:05:59,350 --> 00:05:59,360

335

00:05:59,360 --> 00:06:01,430

They ate rotten meat. When a hunter

336

00:06:01,430 --> 00:06:01,440

337

00:06:01,440 --> 00:06:03,350

killed an animal, they couldn't eat the

338

00:06:03,350 --> 00:06:03,360

339

00:06:03,360 --> 00:06:05,430

whole thing at once. So, they buried it,

340

00:06:05,430 --> 00:06:05,440

341

00:06:05,440 --> 00:06:07,510

stashed it in caves, hid it in cold

342

00:06:07,510 --> 00:06:07,520

343

00:06:07,520 --> 00:06:10,230

streams for days, for weeks, sometimes

344

00:06:10,230 --> 00:06:10,240

345

00:06:10,240 --> 00:06:11,990

months. By the time they came back, the

346

00:06:11,990 --> 00:06:12,000

347

00:06:12,000 --> 00:06:13,670

meat was crawling with maggots and

348

00:06:13,670 --> 00:06:13,680

349

00:06:13,680 --> 00:06:15,909

rireed of decay. They ate it anyway.

350

00:06:15,909 --> 00:06:15,919

351

00:06:15,919 --> 00:06:17,430

Some researchers think they even

352

00:06:17,430 --> 00:06:17,440

353

00:06:17,440 --> 00:06:19,350

preferred it that way. Rotting meat has

354

00:06:19,350 --> 00:06:19,360

355

00:06:19,360 --> 00:06:21,029

already been partly broken down by

356

00:06:21,029 --> 00:06:21,039

357

00:06:21,039 --> 00:06:23,189

bacteria. Easier to chew, easier to

358

00:06:23,189 --> 00:06:23,199

359

00:06:23,199 --> 00:06:25,510

absorb. The bacteria even produce B

360

00:06:25,510 --> 00:06:25,520

361

00:06:25,520 --> 00:06:27,670

vitamins your body needs. Your body

362

00:06:27,670 --> 00:06:27,680

363

00:06:27,680 --> 00:06:29,990

still remembers this. Every fermented

364

00:06:29,990 --> 00:06:30,000

365

00:06:30,000 --> 00:06:33,189

food you love is controlled rot. Cheese,

366

00:06:33,189 --> 00:06:33,199

367

00:06:33,199 --> 00:06:37,590

yogurt, sourdough, beer, wine, soy

368

00:06:37,590 --> 00:06:37,600

369

00:06:37,600 --> 00:06:40,950

sauce, pickles, they are all rot, slowed

370

00:06:40,950 --> 00:06:40,960

371

00:06:40,960 --> 00:06:42,790

down and made safe. Your taste for

372

00:06:42,790 --> 00:06:42,800

373

00:06:42,800 --> 00:06:44,710

cheese didn't develop in a French dairy.

374

00:06:44,710 --> 00:06:44,720

375

00:06:44,720 --> 00:06:46,870

It developed on a savannah a 100,000

376

00:06:46,870 --> 00:06:46,880

377

00:06:46,880 --> 00:06:49,029

years ago. eating something far worse.

378

00:06:49,029 --> 00:06:49,039

379

00:06:49,039 --> 00:06:51,270

Every craving you have today for fat,

380

00:06:51,270 --> 00:06:51,280

381

00:06:51,280 --> 00:06:53,590

for salt, for sugar, for the richest

382

00:06:53,590 --> 00:06:53,600

383

00:06:53,600 --> 00:06:55,430

thing you can find is still running

384

00:06:55,430 --> 00:06:55,440

385

00:06:55,440 --> 00:06:57,350

inside you right now. Your body doesn't

386

00:06:57,350 --> 00:06:57,360

387

00:06:57,360 --> 00:06:58,790

know about grocery stores or

388

00:06:58,790 --> 00:06:58,800

389

00:06:58,800 --> 00:07:01,110

refrigerators. It only knows this. Eat

390

00:07:01,110 --> 00:07:01,120

391

00:07:01,120 --> 00:07:03,430

what's rich. Eat what's rare. Eat while

392

00:07:03,430 --> 00:07:03,440

393

00:07:03,440 --> 00:07:05,430

you can. Because tomorrow there might be

394

00:07:05,430 --> 00:07:05,440

395

00:07:05,440 --> 00:07:07,510

nothing. At 11 p.m. when you open the

396

00:07:07,510 --> 00:07:07,520

397

00:07:07,520 --> 00:07:09,270

fridge, even though you're not hungry,

398

00:07:09,270 --> 00:07:09,280

399

00:07:09,280 --> 00:07:11,110

you're running a 3 million-year-old

400

00:07:11,110 --> 00:07:11,120

401

00:07:11,120 --> 00:07:13,189

program. Still scanning, still trying to

402

00:07:13,189 --> 00:07:13,199

403

00:07:13,199 --> 00:07:15,029

keep you alive. But the world it was

404

00:07:15,029 --> 00:07:15,039

405

00:07:15,039 --> 00:07:17,350

built for is gone. If you took a modern

406

00:07:17,350 --> 00:07:17,360

407

00:07:17,360 --> 00:07:19,189

human and dropped them into the world of

408

00:07:19,189 --> 00:07:19,199

409

00:07:19,199 --> 00:07:21,110

50,000 years ago, they would probably

410

00:07:21,110 --> 00:07:21,120

411

00:07:21,120 --> 00:07:22,950

die in days. You would not know how to

412

00:07:22,950 --> 00:07:22,960

413

00:07:22,960 --> 00:07:24,790

find water. Half the plants would be a

414

00:07:24,790 --> 00:07:24,800

415

00:07:24,800 --> 00:07:26,150

mystery, and you would not be strong

416

00:07:26,150 --> 00:07:26,160

417

00:07:26,160 --> 00:07:28,070

enough to run down an animal, climb a

418

00:07:28,070 --> 00:07:28,080

419

00:07:28,080 --> 00:07:30,150

tree for honey, or crack open a thigh

420

00:07:30,150 --> 00:07:30,160

421

00:07:30,160 --> 00:07:31,749

bone for marrow. You would die staring

422

00:07:31,749 --> 00:07:31,759

423

00:07:31,759 --> 00:07:33,350

at a landscape full of food you could

424

00:07:33,350 --> 00:07:33,360

425

00:07:33,360 --> 00:07:34,629

not see. But if you dropped a

426

00:07:34,629 --> 00:07:34,639

427

00:07:34,639 --> 00:07:36,790

50,000-year-old human into your kitchen,

428

00:07:36,790 --> 00:07:36,800

429

00:07:36,800 --> 00:07:38,309

they would think they had walked into a

430

00:07:38,309 --> 00:07:38,319

431

00:07:38,319 --> 00:07:40,150

god's pantry. They would not understand

432

00:07:40,150 --> 00:07:40,160

433

00:07:40,160 --> 00:07:42,710

any of it. A cold, sweet drink sealed in

434

00:07:42,710 --> 00:07:42,720

435

00:07:42,720 --> 00:07:44,790

metal. Bread that someone else baked.

436

00:07:44,790 --> 00:07:44,800

437

00:07:44,800 --> 00:07:46,710

Milk that sat sealed and fresh for

438

00:07:46,710 --> 00:07:46,720

439

00:07:46,720 --> 00:07:48,629

weeks. Fruit from places they had never

440

00:07:48,629 --> 00:07:48,639

441

00:07:48,639 --> 00:07:51,029
heard of. Food that nobody had to chase.

442
00:07:51,029 --> 00:07:51,039

443
00:07:51,039 --> 00:07:52,550
It would look like the richest place

444
00:07:52,550 --> 00:07:52,560

445
00:07:52,560 --> 00:07:54,950
anyone had ever walked into. For three

446
00:07:54,950 --> 00:07:54,960

447
00:07:54,960 --> 00:07:56,710
million years, every human who ever

448
00:07:56,710 --> 00:07:56,720

449
00:07:56,720 --> 00:07:59,749
lived was hungry, cold, and tired. You

450
00:07:59,749 --> 00:07:59,759

451
00:07:59,759 --> 00:08:01,350
might be the first one who isn't, and

452
00:08:01,350 --> 00:08:01,360

453
00:08:01,360 --> 00:08:04,879
you have no idea how rare that

HOW TO GET TRANSCRIPT: On YouTube, click '...' under the video > 'Show transcript' > copy all lines with timestamps. Then paste directly into the lines above, replacing the placeholder text.

Video description :

682 553 vues 24 avr. 2026 #ancienthumans #humanevolution #weirdhistory

For 3 million years, humans ate things that would horrify you today. Raw bone marrow scraped from bones that hyenas couldn't crack.

Brains pulled from cracked skulls.

Insects by the handful. Rotting meat buried for weeks.

And sometimes, each other.

This is the real story of what ancient humans actually ate, from the African savanna three million years ago to the cave in England where archaeologists found human skulls shaped into cups.

Every craving you have today for fat, for sugar, for salt, for the richest thing you can find, was built by what kept your ancestors alive.

Why cheese is controlled rot.

Why your brain is wired for sugar.

Why one mammoth carcass could change the course of human history.

And why a fifty-thousand-year-old human dropped into your kitchen would think they had walked into a god's pantry.

This isn't the paleo diet you think you know.

This is what the archaeological record actually shows. Bone marrow, scavenging, Oldowan tools, Wonderwerk Cave, the Hadza of Tanzania, Gough's Cave cannibalism, and the deep-time survival program still running inside you right now.

● WATCH - What Did Ancient Humans Do at Night?

- What Did Ancient Humans Do at Night?

● WATCH - What Did Ancient Humans Do All Day?

- What Did Ancient Humans Do All Day?

SOURCES

GOUGH'S CAVE (Somerset, UK): skull cups, cannibalism, zig-zag engraving

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- ▶ Natural History Museum London. "The cannibals of Gough's Cave." Featuring Dr. Silvia Bello.

CALORIC VALUE OF THE HUMAN BODY

- ▶ Cole, J. (2017). "Assessing the calorific significance of episodes of human cannibalism in the Palaeolithic." Scientific Reports, 7: 44707. University of Brighton. The ~125,000-calorie figure. Compares human caloric yield to mammoth, bison, deer.

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- ▶ Berna, Goldberg, Horwitz, Brink, Holt, Bamford & Chazan (2012). "Microstratigraphic evidence of in situ fire in the Acheulean strata of Wonderwerk Cave." PNAS, 109(20): E1215-E1220.

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- ▶ Aiello & Wheeler (1995). "The Expensive-Tissue Hypothesis: The Brain and the Digestive System in Human and Primate Evolution." Current Anthropology, 36(2): 199-221.
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HADZA HUNTER-GATHERERS AND WILD HONEY

- ▶ Marlowe, Berbesque, Wood, Crittenden, Porter & Mabulla (2014). "Honey, Hadza, hunter-gatherers, and human evolution." Journal of Human Evolution, 71: 119-128. The ~15% honey calorie figure.
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- ▶ Pobiner, B. L. (2020). "The zooarchaeology and paleoecology of early hominin scavenging." Evolutionary Anthropology, 29(2): 68-82. Smithsonian.

THE "ROTTEN MEAT" HYPOTHESIS

- ▶ Speth, J. D. (2017). "Putrid Meat and Fish in the Eurasian Middle and Upper Paleolithic." PaleoAnthropology, 2017: 44-72. University of Michigan.

FERMENTATION AND B-VITAMIN PRODUCTION

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► Marco et al. (2017). "Health benefits of fermented foods: microbiota and beyond." Current Opinion in Biotechnology, 44: 94-102.

#ancienthumans #humanevolution #ancientdiet #anthropology
#weirdhistory

7.2 Zenn — 'What Did Ancient Humans Do All Day?' (323K views)

Performance Data

Metric	Value
Views (as of June 2026)	323,372
Likes	7,922
Comments	447
Notable pattern	Second spike in views at Day 30 — likely from cross-linking in 'Eat' video (proof that series format compounds)
Published	May 9, 2026

Key Insight for Your Channel

'All Day' got a second traffic spike because 'Eat' linked to it. Series structure = each new video grows all previous videos. Build trilogies from the start.

Transcript Sample

```
1
00:00:00,000 --> 00:00:00,541
Right now,

2
00:00:00,541 --> 00:00:02,125
somewhere in northern Tanzania,

3
00:00:02,125 --> 00:00:03,041
a Hadza man

4
00:00:03,041 --> 00:00:04,375
is napping in the shade

5
```

00:00:04,375 --> 00:00:05,916
He's done with his work for the day

6
00:00:05,916 --> 00:00:07,333
The Hadza are one of the last

7
00:00:07,333 --> 00:00:08,500
hunter-gatherer groups

8
00:00:08,500 --> 00:00:09,333
left on Earth,

9
00:00:09,333 --> 00:00:10,291
and they still live

10
00:00:10,291 --> 00:00:11,750
the way every human lived

11
00:00:11,750 --> 00:00:13,500
for 300,000 years

12
00:00:13,500 --> 00:00:14,708
Ancient humans worked about

13
00:00:14,708 --> 00:00:16,083
2.5 hours a day

14
00:00:16,083 --> 00:00:16,791
Hunting

15
00:00:16,791 --> 00:00:17,541
Gathering

16
00:00:17,541 --> 00:00:18,291
Cooking

17
00:00:18,291 --> 00:00:19,000
Every chore

18

00:00:19,000 --> 00:00:20,041
that kept them alive.

19
00:00:20,041 --> 00:00:21,708
Most of us hit that before lunch.

20
00:00:21,708 --> 00:00:22,833
They have never been told to

21
00:00:22,833 --> 00:00:24,375
be somewhere at a specific time.

22
00:00:24,375 --> 00:00:25,041
They have almost

23
00:00:25,041 --> 00:00:26,416
none of the chronic diseases

24
00:00:26,416 --> 00:00:27,125
that kill us.

25
00:00:27,125 --> 00:00:28,291
They laugh with their families

26
00:00:28,291 --> 00:00:29,375
more in one afternoon

27
00:00:29,375 --> 00:00:30,166
than most of us laugh

28
00:00:30,166 --> 00:00:31,250
with ours all week

29
00:00:31,250 --> 00:00:32,083
And every researcher

30
00:00:32,083 --> 00:00:32,916
who has lived with them

31

00:00:32,916 --> 00:00:34,625
comes back saying the same thing:

32
00:00:34,625 --> 00:00:36,125
They look happier than we are.

33
00:00:36,125 --> 00:00:37,916
So what do they actually do all day?

34
00:00:37,916 --> 00:00:39,083
In 1968,

35
00:00:39,083 --> 00:00:41,000
an anthropologist named Richard Lee

36
00:00:41,000 --> 00:00:42,125
published years of data

37
00:00:42,125 --> 00:00:43,166
the Kung bushmen

38
00:00:43,166 --> 00:00:44,500
of the Kalahari Desert

39
00:00:44,500 --> 00:00:45,625
He had tracked their time

40
00:00:45,625 --> 00:00:46,500
down to the minute.

41
00:00:46,500 --> 00:00:47,583
His total came to about

42
00:00:47,583 --> 00:00:49,250
15 hours of work per week.

43
00:00:49,250 --> 00:00:50,958
Your ancestors did not have a boss

44

00:00:50,958 --> 00:00:52,083

They did not pay rent

45

00:00:52,083 --> 00:00:53,166

They did not have weekends,

46

00:00:53,166 --> 00:00:54,166

because every day was already

47

00:00:54,166 --> 00:00:55,291

mostly a weekend

48

00:00:55,291 --> 00:00:56,666

So let's walk through their day

49

00:00:56,916 --> 00:00:57,833

Sunrise.

50

00:00:58,041 --> 00:00:59,750

You wake to the sky getting lighter,

51

00:00:59,750 --> 00:01:00,791

the temperature shifting,

52

00:01:00,791 --> 00:01:02,333

the camp moving around you.

53

00:01:02,333 --> 00:01:03,333

You sleep on a hide

54

00:01:03,333 --> 00:01:04,750

laid over flattened grass

55

00:01:04,750 --> 00:01:05,750

maybe a small fire

56

00:01:05,750 --> 00:01:06,458

that someone fed

57

00:01:06,458 --> 00:01:07,291
during the night

58
00:01:07,291 --> 00:01:08,166
Everything you own

59
00:01:08,166 --> 00:01:09,333
fits in a single bag

60
00:01:09,333 --> 00:01:10,166
A digging stick

61
00:01:10,166 --> 00:01:10,916
Or a bow

62
00:01:10,916 --> 00:01:11,750
A few hides

63
00:01:11,750 --> 00:01:12,833
Maybe beads from a daughter

64
00:01:12,833 --> 00:01:13,666
or a sister.

65
00:01:13,666 --> 00:01:14,333
There are roughly

66
00:01:14,333 --> 00:01:15,875
25 to 30 people

67
00:01:15,875 --> 00:01:16,500
in your camp

68
00:01:16,500 --> 00:01:17,833
You know every single one of them

69
00:01:17,833 --> 00:01:18,500
You have known them

70

00:01:18,500 --> 00:01:19,583

your entire life

71

00:01:19,583 --> 00:01:20,458

Your grandmother sleeps

72

00:01:20,458 --> 00:01:21,833

a few feet from your children.

73

00:01:21,833 --> 00:01:23,000

Nobody is on a clock

74

00:01:23,000 --> 00:01:24,416

The first hour is talking

75

00:01:24,416 --> 00:01:26,833

A study by anthropologist Polly Wiesner

76

00:01:26,833 --> 00:01:28,041

found that Bushmen spend

77

00:01:28,041 --> 00:01:29,333

hours every day

78

00:01:29,333 --> 00:01:30,833

in casual conversation

79

00:01:30,833 --> 00:01:31,791

This is not gossip

80

00:01:31,791 --> 00:01:32,916

in the trivial sense

81

00:01:32,916 --> 00:01:33,791

This conversation

82

00:01:33,791 --> 00:01:34,958

is the operating system

83

00:01:34,958 --> 00:01:35,666
of the camp

84
00:01:35,666 --> 00:01:37,041
Who is sleeping with whom?

85
00:01:37,041 --> 00:01:37,458
Who took

86
00:01:37,458 --> 00:01:38,333
more than their share

87
00:01:38,333 --> 00:01:38,916
yesterday?

88
00:01:38,916 --> 00:01:39,833
Who told a good joke

89
00:01:39,833 --> 00:01:40,583
last week?

90
00:01:40,583 --> 00:01:41,541
Who has been quiet

91
00:01:41,541 --> 00:01:42,583
and might be sick?

92
00:01:42,583 --> 00:01:43,750
This is also the entire

93
00:01:43,750 --> 00:01:44,708
legal system

94
00:01:44,708 --> 00:01:46,375
The way the Kung kept order

95
00:01:46,375 --> 00:01:47,916
was by talking about each other

96

00:01:47,916 --> 00:01:49,125

If a man hoarded meat,

97

00:01:49,125 --> 00:01:50,166

people made jokes about him

98

00:01:50,166 --> 00:01:51,125

until he stopped.

99

00:01:51,125 --> 00:01:52,375

If a woman broke a promise,

100

00:01:52,375 --> 00:01:53,458

the whispers traveled

101

00:01:53,458 --> 00:01:54,375

to every camp

102

00:01:54,375 --> 00:01:55,375

within a day's walk.

103

00:01:55,375 --> 00:01:56,833

If you became unbearable,

104

00:01:56,833 --> 00:01:57,375

eventually

105

00:01:57,375 --> 00:01:58,625

no camp would have you

106

00:01:58,625 --> 00:01:59,083

And that

107

00:01:59,083 --> 00:02:00,333

is the harshest punishment

108

00:02:00,333 --> 00:02:02,000

a hunter-gatherer can face

109

00:02:02,000 --> 00:02:02,708

It almost

110

00:02:02,708 --> 00:02:04,250

never had to be used

111

00:02:04,250 --> 00:02:05,375

In 1969,

112

00:02:05,375 --> 00:02:06,750

the anthropologist Richard Lee

113

00:02:06,750 --> 00:02:08,250

saw this happen to himself

114

00:02:08,250 --> 00:02:09,625

He had been living with the Kung

115

00:02:09,625 --> 00:02:10,500

for years

116

00:02:10,500 --> 00:02:11,458

When Christmas came,

117

00:02:11,458 --> 00:02:12,125

he wanted to do

118

00:02:12,125 --> 00:02:13,208

something nice for them

119

00:02:13,208 --> 00:02:14,458

So he bought the biggest,

120

00:02:14,458 --> 00:02:15,375

fattest ox

121

00:02:15,375 --> 00:02:16,041

he could find

122

00:02:16,041 --> 00:02:17,125
and brought it to camp

123

00:02:17,125 --> 00:02:18,416
The Kung made fun of the gift

124

00:02:18,416 --> 00:02:19,208
for weeks.

125

00:02:19,208 --> 00:02:19,875
They told Lee

126

00:02:19,875 --> 00:02:21,208
the ox was too skinny,

127

00:02:21,375 --> 00:02:22,875
the meat would be terrible,

128

00:02:23,000 --> 00:02:24,708
and he had wasted everyone's time.

129

00:02:24,708 --> 00:02:25,750
Lee was confused.

130

00:02:25,750 --> 00:02:27,416
He had checked the ox carefully.

131

00:02:27,416 --> 00:02:28,875
It was a great animal.

132

00:02:28,875 --> 00:02:30,000
So he finally asked

133

00:02:30,000 --> 00:02:31,583
an old man what was going on.

134

00:02:31,583 --> 00:02:32,791
The old man explained:

135

00:02:32,791 --> 00:02:33,708

When a Kung hunter

136

00:02:33,708 --> 00:02:34,958

brings home a big kill,

137

00:02:34,958 --> 00:02:36,541

the camp doesn't celebrate.

138

00:02:36,541 --> 00:02:37,541

They mock it.

139

00:02:37,541 --> 00:02:39,083

They say the kill is small

140

00:02:39,083 --> 00:02:40,583

the meat is bad.

141

00:02:40,583 --> 00:02:41,958

The bigger the kill,

142

00:02:41,958 --> 00:02:43,208

the harder they mock.

143

00:02:43,208 --> 00:02:44,458

That is how the Kung

144

00:02:44,458 --> 00:02:45,416

keep their hunters

145

00:02:45,416 --> 00:02:46,291

from thinking they are

146

00:02:46,291 --> 00:02:47,500

better than everyone else.

147

00:02:47,500 --> 00:02:48,083

They had been doing

148

00:02:48,083 --> 00:02:49,291
the same thing to Lee.

149

00:02:49,291 --> 00:02:50,750
He had brought a great gift,

150

00:02:50,750 --> 00:02:51,416
so they had to

151

00:02:51,416 --> 00:02:52,833
cut him down to size.

152

00:02:52,833 --> 00:02:53,791
In a Kung camp,

153

00:02:53,791 --> 00:02:55,083
no one is allowed to feel

154

00:02:55,083 --> 00:02:56,208
above anyone else.

155

00:02:56,208 --> 00:02:57,041
Every joke,

156

00:02:57,041 --> 00:02:57,916
every complaint,

157

00:02:57,916 --> 00:02:59,291
every whispered story

158

00:02:59,291 --> 00:03:00,375
is a tiny tool

159

00:03:00,375 --> 00:03:01,791
for keeping people equal.

160

00:03:01,791 --> 00:03:02,958
We built prisons.

161

00:03:02,958 --> 00:03:03,875

They handled things by

162

00:03:03,875 --> 00:03:04,958

talking to each other.

163

00:03:05,333 --> 00:03:06,541

Mid-morning.

164

00:03:06,916 --> 00:03:07,916

The men start to gather

165

00:03:07,916 --> 00:03:08,625

for the hunt.

166

00:03:08,625 --> 00:03:09,833

Hunting is dramatic.

167

00:03:09,833 --> 00:03:11,375

It is also unreliable.

168

00:03:11,375 --> 00:03:12,250

Frank Marlow,

169

00:03:12,250 --> 00:03:13,208

who studied the Hadza

170

00:03:13,208 --> 00:03:14,208

for decades,

171

00:03:14,208 --> 00:03:15,083

found that on

172

00:03:15,083 --> 00:03:16,166

any given day,

173

00:03:16,166 --> 00:03:17,583

most hunters come home

174

00:03:17,583 --> 00:03:18,458
empty-handed.

175

00:03:18,458 --> 00:03:19,583
A successful kill happens

176

00:03:19,583 --> 00:03:21,291
maybe once every few days,

177

00:03:21,291 --> 00:03:22,333
sometimes less.

178

00:03:22,333 --> 00:03:23,375
A Hadza hunter might

179

00:03:23,375 --> 00:03:24,750
walk 20 miles in a day,

180

00:03:24,916 --> 00:03:25,541
track a wounded

181

00:03:25,541 --> 00:03:26,750
animal for hours,

182

00:03:26,916 --> 00:03:27,583
lose it,

183

00:03:27,750 --> 00:03:28,416
and come home with

184

00:03:28,416 --> 00:03:29,708
nothing but a few small birds

185

00:03:29,708 --> 00:03:30,583
and a sore back.

186

00:03:30,708 --> 00:03:31,125
But,

187

00:03:31,125 --> 00:03:32,291
when they do connect,

188

00:03:32,291 --> 00:03:33,250
they connect hard.

189

00:03:33,250 --> 00:03:34,166
Their arrows are tipped with

190

00:03:34,166 --> 00:03:35,333
poison from the sap

191

00:03:35,333 --> 00:03:36,375
of a desert rose.

192

00:03:36,375 --> 00:03:37,333
The hunter shoots,

193

00:03:37,333 --> 00:03:38,750
then tracks the animal for hours

194

00:03:38,750 --> 00:03:39,916
while the poison works.

195

00:03:39,916 --> 00:03:40,583
They have brought down

196

00:03:40,583 --> 00:03:41,583
everything from antelope

197

00:03:41,583 --> 00:03:42,833
to giraffe this way.

198

00:03:42,833 --> 00:03:44,583
And yet, the hunters are not

199

00:03:44,583 --> 00:03:46,083
the ones who feed the camp.

200

00:03:46,083 --> 00:03:46,916

The women are.

201

00:03:47,208 --> 00:03:48,458

Among the Hadza, women

202

00:03:48,458 --> 00:03:49,541

provide more than half

203

00:03:49,541 --> 00:03:50,791

of the camp's calories.

204

00:03:50,791 --> 00:03:52,500

They go out in groups of 3 to 8

205

00:03:52,500 --> 00:03:53,291

every day

206

00:03:53,291 --> 00:03:54,041

They climb,

207

00:03:54,041 --> 00:03:54,708

dig,

208

00:03:54,708 --> 00:03:55,583

and gather,

209

00:03:55,583 --> 00:03:56,666

returning with steady food

210

00:03:56,666 --> 00:03:58,333

that does not depend on luck.

211

00:03:58,333 --> 00:03:59,291

That walk back

212

00:03:59,291 --> 00:04:00,416

is where most of the camp's

213

00:04:00,416 --> 00:04:01,458
gossip and decisions

214
00:04:01,458 --> 00:04:02,500
actually happen.

215
00:04:02,500 --> 00:04:03,791
The men feast you,

216
00:04:03,791 --> 00:04:04,875
the women feed you.

217
00:04:04,875 --> 00:04:06,291
The most productive gatherers

218
00:04:06,291 --> 00:04:06,875
in the camp

219
00:04:06,875 --> 00:04:08,291
are usually the grandmothers.

220
00:04:08,291 --> 00:04:09,916
Women in their 50s and 60s

221
00:04:09,916 --> 00:04:11,416
bring back more food per day

222
00:04:11,416 --> 00:04:12,875
than mothers in their 20s.

223
00:04:12,875 --> 00:04:13,750
Many of them are still

224
00:04:13,750 --> 00:04:15,041
walking five to 10 miles

225
00:04:15,041 --> 00:04:16,083
into their 70s.

226

00:04:16,083 --> 00:04:17,416

Anthropologists call this

227

00:04:17,416 --> 00:04:19,041

the grandmother hypothesis.

228

00:04:19,041 --> 00:04:20,041

It explains why humans

229

00:04:20,041 --> 00:04:21,541

are the only primate species

230

00:04:21,541 --> 00:04:22,375

whose women live for

231

00:04:22,375 --> 00:04:23,666

decades past menopause.

232

00:04:23,666 --> 00:04:24,541

The idea is that

233

00:04:24,541 --> 00:04:26,000

grandmothers feeding their grandchildren

234

00:04:26,250 --> 00:04:27,916

made the whole species more successful.

235

00:04:28,250 --> 00:04:29,250

The children come with them.

236

00:04:29,458 --> 00:04:30,458

A Hadza three-year-old

237

00:04:30,458 --> 00:04:31,916

plays with a small digging stick

238

00:04:31,916 --> 00:04:33,000

next to her mother, who is

239

00:04:33,000 --> 00:04:34,166
digging up the day's food.

240

00:04:34,208 --> 00:04:36,583
By six, she can find food on her own.

241

00:04:36,583 --> 00:04:37,958
By 10, she is contributing

242

00:04:37,958 --> 00:04:39,375
meaningfully to the family.

243

00:04:39,375 --> 00:04:41,291
By eight, a Hadza boy can be

244

00:04:41,291 --> 00:04:42,958
sent out alone with his bow

245

00:04:42,958 --> 00:04:44,166
and come back with a bird.

246

00:04:44,166 --> 00:04:45,041
That is just

247

00:04:45,041 --> 00:04:46,333
what an eight-year-old does.

248

00:04:46,333 --> 00:04:48,083
Anthropologist David Lancy

249

00:04:48,083 --> 00:04:48,958
studied dozens

250

00:04:48,958 --> 00:04:50,333
of traditional communities

251

00:04:50,333 --> 00:04:51,875
and found that children spent

252

00:04:51,875 --> 00:04:52,750
most of their day

253

00:04:52,750 --> 00:04:54,291
in mixed-age play groups.

254

00:04:54,291 --> 00:04:55,250
Older kids

255

00:04:55,250 --> 00:04:56,541
taught younger kids.

256

00:04:56,541 --> 00:04:57,083
Adults

257

00:04:57,083 --> 00:04:58,375
rarely interfered.

258

00:04:58,375 --> 00:04:59,375
A child who fell down

259

00:04:59,375 --> 00:05:00,166
was usually picked up

260

00:05:00,166 --> 00:05:01,125
by another child.

261

00:05:01,125 --> 00:05:02,291
A child who asked a question

262

00:05:02,291 --> 00:05:03,416
was usually answered

263

00:05:03,416 --> 00:05:04,083
by a sibling.

264

00:05:04,083 --> 00:05:04,541
This is how

265

00:05:04,541 --> 00:05:05,541
human children learned

266

00:05:05,541 --> 00:05:06,125
for hundreds

267

00:05:06,125 --> 00:05:07,291
of thousands of years.

268

00:05:07,291 --> 00:05:08,041
Through watching,

269

00:05:08,041 --> 00:05:08,833
copying, and playing

270

00:05:08,833 --> 00:05:09,291
at the work

271

00:05:09,291 --> 00:05:10,041
the adults were doing

272

00:05:10,041 --> 00:05:11,125
right next to them

273

00:05:11,125 --> 00:05:11,916
this is the school

274

00:05:11,916 --> 00:05:13,375
humans evolved to attend.

275

00:05:13,666 --> 00:05:14,583
Midday.

276

00:05:15,083 --> 00:05:16,583
The first food returns to camp.

277

00:05:16,583 --> 00:05:17,875
It gets shared immediately.

278

00:05:17,875 --> 00:05:19,375
Sharing is not optional.

279
00:05:19,375 --> 00:05:20,250
It's a rule.

280
00:05:20,250 --> 00:05:21,166
If a Hadza man

281
00:05:21,166 --> 00:05:22,166
kills a large animal,

282
00:05:22,166 --> 00:05:23,583
he does not own that meat.

283
00:05:23,583 --> 00:05:24,583
He distributes it.

284
00:05:24,583 --> 00:05:25,833
The hunter himself often

285
00:05:25,833 --> 00:05:27,250
gets one of the worst cuts.

286
00:05:27,250 --> 00:05:28,541
The camp gets the rest.

287
00:05:28,541 --> 00:05:29,541
Anthropologists think

288
00:05:29,541 --> 00:05:30,708
this constant sharing

289
00:05:30,708 --> 00:05:31,500
is one of the things

290
00:05:31,500 --> 00:05:32,791
that built the human brain.

291

00:05:32,791 --> 00:05:34,583
Tracking who gave what to whom

292
00:05:34,583 --> 00:05:35,708
who skipped a turn,

293
00:05:35,708 --> 00:05:37,000
who stepped up when it mattered.

294
00:05:37,000 --> 00:05:39,083
That is a level of social arithmetic

295
00:05:39,083 --> 00:05:40,875
no other species has ever needed.

296
00:05:40,875 --> 00:05:42,875
Generosity is the savings account.

297
00:05:43,041 --> 00:05:44,041
Afternoon.

298
00:05:44,208 --> 00:05:45,791
After eating, the camp slows.

299
00:05:45,791 --> 00:05:47,541
The middle of the day is hot.

300
00:05:47,541 --> 00:05:48,833
Nobody works through the heat.

301
00:05:48,833 --> 00:05:49,708
People nap,

302
00:05:49,708 --> 00:05:50,708
sit in shade,

303
00:05:50,708 --> 00:05:51,791
repair arrows,

304

00:05:51,791 --> 00:05:53,416

weave grass into baskets,

305

00:05:53,416 --> 00:05:54,916

pick lice from each other's hair,

306

00:05:54,916 --> 00:05:56,875

which sounds gross but takes an hour

307

00:05:56,875 --> 00:05:58,041

and is mostly an excuse

308

00:05:58,041 --> 00:05:59,083

to be physically close

309

00:05:59,083 --> 00:06:00,083

to people you love.

310

00:06:00,083 --> 00:06:01,083

The middle of the day

311

00:06:01,083 --> 00:06:02,083

is for the body.

312

00:06:02,083 --> 00:06:03,583

If you have to relieve yourself,

313

00:06:03,583 --> 00:06:04,583

you walk a short distance

314

00:06:04,583 --> 00:06:05,500

into the bush.

315

00:06:05,500 --> 00:06:06,666

There is no toilet paper.

316

00:06:06,666 --> 00:06:07,666

There are leaves,

317

00:06:07,666 --> 00:06:08,416

sand,

318

00:06:08,416 --> 00:06:09,083

water.

319

00:06:09,083 --> 00:06:10,333

You don't think much about it.

320

00:06:10,333 --> 00:06:11,083

If you are a woman

321

00:06:11,083 --> 00:06:12,083

and you are bleeding,

322

00:06:12,083 --> 00:06:13,125

you use soft grass

323

00:06:13,125 --> 00:06:14,000

or moss.

324

00:06:14,000 --> 00:06:14,625

Some groups

325

00:06:14,625 --> 00:06:16,125

isolate menstruating women.

326

00:06:16,125 --> 00:06:17,708

The Hadza do not.

327

00:06:17,708 --> 00:06:18,958

You go about your day.

328

00:06:18,958 --> 00:06:20,166

If you want to have sex,

329

00:06:20,166 --> 00:06:21,375

you have sex.

330

00:06:21,375 --> 00:06:22,500

Hunter-gatherer cultures

331

00:06:22,500 --> 00:06:24,166

don't pile shame on top of it.

332

00:06:24,166 --> 00:06:25,916

There is privacy when people want it

333

00:06:25,916 --> 00:06:28,375

but not the heavy taboo we attach to it.

334

00:06:28,375 --> 00:06:28,875

And yes,

335

00:06:28,875 --> 00:06:30,500

conflicts do happen sometimes.

336

00:06:30,500 --> 00:06:31,833

These people are human,

337

00:06:31,833 --> 00:06:32,708

not saints.

338

00:06:32,708 --> 00:06:33,541

Affairs,

339

00:06:33,541 --> 00:06:34,291

jealousy,

340

00:06:34,291 --> 00:06:35,375

stolen tools,

341

00:06:35,375 --> 00:06:36,750

grudges that flare up.

342

00:06:36,750 --> 00:06:37,583

But the way conflicts

343

00:06:37,583 --> 00:06:38,666
ended was different.

344

00:06:38,666 --> 00:06:39,583
In a culture where you

345

00:06:39,583 --> 00:06:41,125
can pack everything you own

346

00:06:41,125 --> 00:06:42,083
in 15 minutes

347

00:06:42,083 --> 00:06:43,250
and walk to the next camp,

348

00:06:43,250 --> 00:06:44,583
most disputes ended by

349

00:06:44,583 --> 00:06:46,208
one party simply leaving.

350

00:06:46,208 --> 00:06:47,416
The Bushmen called this

351

00:06:47,416 --> 00:06:48,666
"voting with your feet"

352

00:06:48,666 --> 00:06:50,000
If you couldn't stand someone,

353

00:06:50,000 --> 00:06:50,875
you went somewhere else

354

00:06:50,875 --> 00:06:51,625
for a few weeks.

355

00:06:51,625 --> 00:06:52,625
By the time you came back,

356

00:06:52,625 --> 00:06:53,833
the heat had passed.

357
00:06:53,833 --> 00:06:55,083
Most of us cannot do that

358
00:06:55,083 --> 00:06:56,125
with a mortgage and a job.

359
00:06:56,500 --> 00:06:57,541
Late afternoon.

360
00:06:57,833 --> 00:06:59,333
The pace picks up again.

361
00:06:59,458 --> 00:07:00,791
People visit other camps,

362
00:07:00,791 --> 00:07:02,583
a few miles walk to see relatives

363
00:07:02,583 --> 00:07:03,708
trade gossip,

364
00:07:03,708 --> 00:07:05,000
maybe a range of marriage.

365
00:07:05,000 --> 00:07:06,375
The same handful of camps

366
00:07:06,375 --> 00:07:07,791
stay connected this way,

367
00:07:07,791 --> 00:07:08,791
year after year,

368
00:07:09,000 --> 00:07:10,666
generation after generation.

369

00:07:10,666 --> 00:07:11,833

By adulthood,

370

00:07:11,833 --> 00:07:13,166

you know more than a hundred

371

00:07:13,166 --> 00:07:14,291

people personally.

372

00:07:14,291 --> 00:07:15,208

Every one of them

373

00:07:15,208 --> 00:07:16,750

by name and full history.

374

00:07:16,750 --> 00:07:17,916

The hunters return.

375

00:07:17,916 --> 00:07:19,333

Some days they have a kill,

376

00:07:19,333 --> 00:07:20,583

most days they don't.

377

00:07:20,583 --> 00:07:22,041

The women who gathered all day

378

00:07:22,041 --> 00:07:23,791

quietly become the day's heroes

379

00:07:23,791 --> 00:07:24,583

whenever the hunters

380

00:07:24,583 --> 00:07:26,000

come back empty-handed,

381

00:07:26,000 --> 00:07:27,083

which is most of the time.

382

00:07:27,333 --> 00:07:28,291

Evening.

383

00:07:28,416 --> 00:07:29,541

Cooking begins.

384

00:07:29,541 --> 00:07:31,041

roasting roots in coals,

385

00:07:31,041 --> 00:07:31,666

boiling meat

386

00:07:31,666 --> 00:07:33,291

in pouches with hot stones.

387

00:07:33,291 --> 00:07:34,250

splitting fruit,

388

00:07:34,250 --> 00:07:36,125

chewing seeds soft for the children.

389

00:07:36,125 --> 00:07:37,500

Then comes the meal,

390

00:07:37,500 --> 00:07:38,541

the whole camp.

391

00:07:38,541 --> 00:07:39,291

Everyone.

392

00:07:39,291 --> 00:07:40,250

They have done this together

393

00:07:40,250 --> 00:07:42,583

every night for 300,000 years.

394

00:07:42,583 --> 00:07:44,041

This is not paradise.

395

00:07:44,041 --> 00:07:44,958

They get sick,

396

00:07:44,958 --> 00:07:46,125

bury children,

397

00:07:46,125 --> 00:07:47,583

lose people they love,

398

00:07:47,583 --> 00:07:48,708

they fight and grieve

399

00:07:48,708 --> 00:07:49,791

like anyone else.

400

00:07:49,791 --> 00:07:50,666

But there is a kind of

401

00:07:50,666 --> 00:07:52,541

suffering they do not seem to know.

402

00:07:52,541 --> 00:07:53,666

The slow modern ache

403

00:07:53,666 --> 00:07:54,666

of working at a job

404

00:07:54,666 --> 00:07:55,708

we don't believe in

405

00:07:55,708 --> 00:07:56,541

to pay for a life

406

00:07:56,541 --> 00:07:58,041

that never quite arrives.

407

00:07:58,041 --> 00:07:58,666

Lying awake,

408

00:07:58,666 --> 00:07:59,541
comparing ourselves

409

00:07:59,541 --> 00:08:00,208
to strangers

410

00:08:00,208 --> 00:08:00,875
we suspect

411

00:08:00,875 --> 00:08:02,333
are happier than we are.

412

00:08:02,333 --> 00:08:03,833
In the late 1960s,

413

00:08:03,833 --> 00:08:04,875
an anthropologist

414

00:08:04,875 --> 00:08:06,125
looking at all this evidence,

415

00:08:06,125 --> 00:08:07,208
called early humans

416

00:08:07,208 --> 00:08:09,250
the original affluent society.

417

00:08:09,250 --> 00:08:10,583
He didn't mean they had wealth.

418

00:08:10,583 --> 00:08:11,666
They had almost nothing.

419

00:08:11,666 --> 00:08:12,875
He meant they had time.

420

00:08:12,875 --> 00:08:13,916
We made trades,

421

00:08:13,916 --> 00:08:14,708
real ones.

422
00:08:14,708 --> 00:08:15,833
We got vaccines,

423
00:08:15,833 --> 00:08:16,666
antibiotics

424
00:08:16,666 --> 00:08:17,583
and refrigeration

425
00:08:17,583 --> 00:08:18,583
and indoor plumbing.

426
00:08:18,583 --> 00:08:20,041
We got much longer lives.

427
00:08:20,041 --> 00:08:20,958
We got fewer children

428
00:08:20,958 --> 00:08:22,500
dying before they turned 5,

429
00:08:22,500 --> 00:08:23,833
which in a hunter-gatherer camp

430
00:08:23,833 --> 00:08:24,916
used to happen to roughly

431
00:08:24,916 --> 00:08:26,083
4 out of every 10.

432
00:08:26,083 --> 00:08:27,333
We got real wins.

433
00:08:27,333 --> 00:08:29,000
Nobody is suggesting we go back.

434

00:08:29,000 --> 00:08:29,833

But we also made

435

00:08:29,833 --> 00:08:31,125

trades we don't talk about.

436

00:08:31,125 --> 00:08:32,583

We invented agriculture.

437

00:08:32,583 --> 00:08:33,416

We invented work

438

00:08:33,416 --> 00:08:34,750

that someone else owns.

439

00:08:34,750 --> 00:08:36,000

We invented bosses,

440

00:08:36,000 --> 00:08:36,750

and bills

441

00:08:36,750 --> 00:08:38,291

You inherited their bodies

442

00:08:38,291 --> 00:08:39,541

The same nervous systems

443

00:08:39,541 --> 00:08:40,958

The same need for sun,

444

00:08:40,958 --> 00:08:41,791

sleep,

445

00:08:41,791 --> 00:08:42,458

touch,

446

00:08:42,458 --> 00:08:43,375

conversation,

447

00:08:43,375 --> 00:08:44,541
and time spent doing

448

00:08:44,541 --> 00:08:45,500
genuinely nothing.

449

00:08:45,500 --> 00:08:47,041
We are still hunter-gatherers.

450

00:08:47,250 --> 00:08:48,708
We just stopped doing it.

Description :

The Hadza of northern Tanzania still live the way every human lived for three hundred thousand years.

About two and a half hours of work a day. The rest is theirs.

This video walks through one full day of an ancient human life.

The hunting that mostly fails.

The women who actually feed the camp.

The grandmothers who outwork everyone.

The eight-year-olds who hunt birds alone.

The way they keep order without police, raise children without daycare, handle conflict without lawyers.

You will recognize parts of yourself in this day.

Your body still expects to be living it.

The work of Richard Lee, Frank Marlowe, Polly Wiessner, David Lancy, and Marshall Sahlins rewrote what scientists thought about prehistoric life.

Most of our ancestors worked less than you do.

We made trades. Vaccines, refrigeration, longer lives, fewer children dying before five. Those gains are real.

But we also invented agriculture. We invented work that someone else owns. We invented bosses and bills.

We are still hunter-gatherers. We just stopped doing it.

MORE VIDEOS LIKE THIS

What Did Ancient Humans Do at Night?

- What Did Ancient Humans Do at Night?

What Did Ancient Humans Actually Eat?

- What Did Ancient Humans Actually Eat?

SOURCES

WORK HOURS

Lee, Richard B. (1968). "What Hunters Do for a Living." In *Man the Hunter*, Aldine.
Source for the fifteen-hour work week and the two and a half hours per day figure.

THE CHRISTMAS OX

Lee, Richard B. (1969). "Eating Christmas in the Kalahari." *Natural History* magazine.
Source for the Christmas-ox story and the quoted explanation.

CONVERSATION

Wiessner, Polly W. (2014). "Embers of Society." PNAS, 111(39).

Source for Bushmen daily conversation patterns.

HADZA ETHNOGRAPHY

Marlowe, Frank W. (2010). The Hadza: Hunter-Gatherers of Tanzania. UC Press.

Source for camp size, hunting failure rates, women's calorie contribution, sharing rules.

GRANDMOTHER HYPOTHESIS

Hawkes, Kristen, et al. (1989+). Studies of Hadza foraging by post-reproductive women.

Source for grandmother productivity and human female longevity past menopause.

CHILDREN'S LEARNING

Lancy, David F. (2008). The Anthropology of Childhood. Cambridge University Press.

Source for mixed-age play groups.

HADZA CHILDREN HUNTING

Crittenden, Alyssa N., et al. (2013). "Juvenile foraging among the Hadza." Evolution and Human Behavior, 34(4).

Source for eight-year-olds hunting alone.

POISON ARROWS

Wood, Brian M., et al. (2014). Documentation of Hadza arrow poison.

Source for arrow poison from the desert rose plant called panjube.

ORIGINAL AFFLUENT SOCIETY

Sahlins, Marshall (1972). "The Original Affluent Society." Stone Age Economics. Aldine.

Source for the original affluent society framing.

HUMAN ORIGINS

Hublin, Jean-Jacques, et al. (2017). "New fossils from Jebel Irhoud." Nature, 546.

Source for the three hundred thousand year figure.

CONFLICT RESOLUTION

Boehm, Christopher (1999). Hierarchy in the Forest. Harvard University Press.

Source for voting with your feet and egalitarian conflict resolution.

7.3 Additional Viral Reference Slots

Add more viral video analyses below as you discover them. Copy the format from 7.1.

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

VIRAL VIDEO REFERENCE SLOT — [Channel Name] / [Video Title] Screenshot + performance data + transcript excerpt + key insights

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

VIRAL VIDEO REFERENCE SLOT — [Channel Name] / [Video Title] Screenshot + performance data + transcript excerpt + key insights

SECTION 8 — MONETIZATION MAP

8.1 Revenue Stack (in order of activation)

Stage	Revenue Stream
0-1K subs	None — focus on content quality and growth only
1K subs + 4K watch hours	YouTube Partner Program (AdSense). Expected RPM: \$7-15 for this niche. At 100K views/month: \$700-1,500/month.
10K subs	Channel Membership. Tier 1 (\$2.99): early access. Tier 2 (\$9.99): deeper research notes + sources PDF per video.
20K subs	Digital Products: 'Ancestral Mind Workbook' — a \$19-29 PDF/Gumroad product. 'The Mismatch Field Guide' — list of papers + protocols.
30K subs	Affiliate: BetterHelp (\$150/conversion). Skillshare / MasterClass (\$30-50/conversion). Ancestral health supplements (Natural Force, Athletic Greens etc.)
50K+ subs	Brand deals. Target sponsors: wellness brands, sleep tech, nootropics, productivity tools, documentary platforms, book publishers in psychology/anthropology.

8.2 CPM Projections

Based on niche research (OutlierKit + Mediacube 2026 data):

- Education + Psychology content: \$4-12 RPM average
- Wellness/ancestral health angle adds: +\$3-8 RPM for health advertisers
- US/UK/AU audience (likely majority given English content): premium CPM tier
- Realistic RPM at scale: \$8-15 per 1,000 views
- At 500K views/month (achievable Year 2): \$4,000-7,500/month from AdSense alone

8.3 Sponsorship Targets

- Ancestral health / real food brands: Paleo valley, US Wellness Meats, Wild Pastures
- Sleep & recovery: Eight Sleep, Oura Ring, Whoop
- Nootropics / brain health: Qualia, Neurohacker Collective, Magic Mind
- Mental health platforms: BetterHelp, Headspace, Calm
- Books / audio: Audible, Blinkist — perfect for a deep-reading audience
- Education: Skillshare, MasterClass, Coursera

SECTION 9 — COMPETITIVE DIFFERENTIATION

9.1 How This Channel Differs From Zenn

Dimension	How We Differ
Niche angle	Zenn documents ancient life. We explain why ancient life matters for YOUR life TODAY. Zenn is museum. We are mirror.
Emotional hook	Zenn is anthropological curiosity. We are personal diagnosis. The viewer watches because it explains something they feel, not just something they wonder about.
Keyword territory	We own 'evolutionary mismatch', 'ancestral brain', 'hunter gatherer happiness' — terms Zenn never uses and never will. We can rank first because we got there first.
Shorts strategy	Zenn has zero Shorts. We produce a Short for every long video. Double distribution surface from Day 1.
Monetization	Zenn earns on views. We earn on wellness affiliate programs — much higher per-conversion revenue in health/psychology space.

9.2 How This Channel Differs From Dark Psychology Channels

Dimension	How We Differ
Scientific rigor	Dark psychology channels cite no sources. We cite peer-reviewed papers in every description. Higher trust, higher retention, better SEO.
Tone	Dark psychology is manipulative-feel, often sensationalist. We are measured, documentary. Better CPM audience, better brand deal eligibility.
Depth	Dark psychology videos are often 3-6 minutes, surface-level. We do 8-12 minutes, deeply sourced. Higher watch time = better algorithm treatment.
Unique angle	We explain dark psychology through evolutionary science, not through social manipulation tips. We're the scientist, not the tactician.

9.3 The Moat: Why This Niche Is Defensible

- First-mover on 'evolutionary mismatch' as a YouTube channel identity
- Source-backed content creates compound authority — harder to replicate quickly
- Series architecture (trilogies) means each new video is cross-supported by existing audience

- Niche sits at the crossroads of two exploding trends (ancient humans + why modern life is broken) — it benefits from both algorithm signals

SECTION 10 — PRODUCTION WORKFLOW

10.1 One-Video Production Cycle (7-Day Loop)

Day	Task
Day 1	Topic research: Identify mismatch concept, find 2-3 peer-reviewed sources, scan vidIQ for keyword opportunity
Day 2	Script outline: map the 7-beat structure, write hook and close first, then fill middle
Day 3	Full script: write complete narration text (target: 1,200-1,800 words for 8-12 min video)
Day 4	Voice recording OR AI voice generation (ElevenLabs v3 recommended — natural tone). Stock footage pull from Pexels, Storyblocks, or Pond5.
Day 5	Video edit: assemble footage + narration, add text overlays, color grade (warm ancient / cool modern split)
Day 6	Thumbnail creation, title A/B testing (2 variants), description writing, tags
Day 7	Upload, publish at optimal time (Thursday 2-4pm ET for US audience), schedule Short from same video

10.2 Tools Stack

- Script: Claude (AI) for first draft, Hemingway App for clarity check
- Voice: ElevenLabs v2 Multilingual -> American English voice, provide me a real-world personality whose voice is ideal for our channel, so i gonna clone it with elevenlabs
- Footage : Generate them using my google AI pro plan through antigravity Ide or Andtigravity CLI
- Editing: CapCut (free), Thumbnail: Canva Pro
- Research: Google Scholar, Semantic Scholar, PubMed (all free) or Crawler mcp, use the find-skill or request user to install a specific mcp for research
- SEO: vidIQ (connected) for keyword research and competitor tracking
- Analytics: native YouTube Studio

SECTION 11 — FIRST 10 VIDEOS (Fully Developed Concepts)

Video 1 — 'Why You Can't Stop Scrolling (Your Brain Is Still Hunting)'

PILLAR 1 — Modern Problem Explained by Ancient Biology

TARGET KEYWORD phone addiction brain / why can't I stop scrolling

HOOK Every time you pick up your phone, your dopamine system fires the same signal it fired when your ancestors found food in the forest.

Core science: Dopamine is a foraging signal, not a pleasure signal. The VTA-nucleus accumbens pathway was designed to motivate searching for resources. Social media uses variable reward (the scroll refresh) to hijack this pathway infinitely. The ancient mechanism found its match — and it cannot stop.

Key studies to cite: Hofmann et al. (2012) on desire strength — smartphone vs food/sleep. Ward et al. (2017) on cognitive capacity and phone proximity. Wu et al. (2016) on intermittent reinforcement and dopamine.

- Opening shot idea: extreme close-up on a human thumb scrolling, slow motion — then cut to hands picking berries from a bush
- Resonant close idea: 'Your ancestors stopped when they found what they were looking for. You never find it. And that is the trap.'

Video 2 — 'The Real Reason Modern People Are So Lonely'

PILLAR 1

TARGET KEYWORD why am I lonely / modern loneliness science

HOOK Loneliness in modern humans triggers the same stress hormones as physical pain. In a world of 8 billion people, most of us have never felt more alone.

Core science: Humans evolved to live in tribes of 100-150 people (Dunbar's Number). The tribe was the survival unit — exile meant death. Loneliness was a pain signal to return to the group. Modern cities have millions of people and almost no tribe. The pain signal fires constantly because it can never be resolved.

Key studies: Cacioppo & Patrick (2008) 'Loneliness: Human Nature and the Need for Social Connection'. Dunbar's band size research. Holt-Lunstad meta-analysis (2015) — loneliness equivalent to smoking 15 cigarettes/day in mortality risk.

Video 3 — 'Your Anxiety Is Not a Disorder. It's Ancient Software.'

PILLAR 1

TARGET KEYWORD anxiety explained science / why do I have anxiety

HOOK Anxiety is not a malfunction. It is a predator-detection system running in a world with no predators.

Core science: The amygdala evolved for threat detection in environments where threats were physical, immediate, and usually resolved (predator attacks). Modern threats are chronic, abstract, and unresolvable (finances, social status, future worries). The ancient alarm cannot turn off because the threat never ends.

Video 4 — 'Why Humans Were Never Built to Work 8 Hours a Day'

PILLAR 1

TARGET KEYWORD burnout science / why work feels so hard

HOOK Hunter-gatherers worked an average of 2.5 hours a day to meet all their survival needs. We call the rest of their time 'leisure'. They called it 'life'.

Core science: Richard Lee's famous Kung Bushmen study (1968). The 40-hour work week is 150 years old. The human body's cortisol rhythm is calibrated for intermittent effort, not sustained 8-hour output. Burnout is not weakness — it is the body correctly signaling that the workload is evolutionarily abnormal.

Video 5 — 'Why Hunter-Gatherers Were Happier Than You'

PILLAR 2 — Anchor Series (Ancient Life)

TARGET KEYWORD hunter gatherer happiness / ancient humans happy

HOOK Clinical depression affects 5% of the modern world. Among the Kaluli of Papua New Guinea — a traditional foraging society — the rate is 1 in 2,000.

Core science: Brescoll (2012) Kaluli depression data. Hidaka (2012) 'Depression as a disease of modernity'. The ancestral environment provided: constant social contact, physical activity, direct competence feedback, natural light, sleep-wake rhythm, diet variety, meaning through survival tasks. Modern life strips most of these.

Video 6 — 'What Your Phone Is Doing to Your Tribal Brain'

PILLAR 1 + 3 (Dark Hook)

TARGET KEYWORD social media brain science / phone addiction psychology

HOOK Your brain was not designed for 1,000 social comparisons per day. It was designed for 150.

Core science: Social comparison theory (Festinger, 1954) + evolutionary status psychology. Instagram/TikTok expose the human social comparison system to a volume 10x-100x above ancestral baseline. The result is a constant low-level status threat signal with no resolution.

Video 7 — 'The Science of Why We Evolved to Gossip'

PILLAR 3 — Dark Hook**TARGET KEYWORD** why do humans gossip / gossip psychology science**HOOK** Gossip is not a character flaw. It is a coalition surveillance system that kept your ancestors alive.

Core science: Dunbar's social bonding research — language evolved for social information exchange, not abstract communication. Gossip occupies ~65% of human conversation time (Dunbar, 1996). It serves: alliance monitoring, reputation tracking, threat assessment. Office gossip is ancient politics.

Video 8 — 'Why You Feel Worse After Social Media (Ancient Reason)'

PILLAR 1**TARGET KEYWORD** why social media makes you feel bad / social media anxiety**HOOK** Every time you open Instagram, your brain runs a status check. And in a world of 8 billion curated highlights, you always lose.

Core science: Evolutionary mismatch in social comparison. The sociometer (Leary, 1995) — a continuous self-esteem tracker evolved to monitor social standing in a small tribe. On social media, it is exposed to an infinite pool of artificially inflated status signals. The meter breaks.

Video 9 — 'Why Modern Children Are Struggling (Evolution's Answer)'

PILLAR 1**TARGET KEYWORD** kids mental health crisis / why are children anxious**HOOK** Human children evolved to learn through unsupervised play in mixed-age groups. We gave them supervised single-age classrooms and screens instead.

Core science: Lancy (2008) 'Anthropology of Childhood' — in foraging societies, children had 8+ hours of free play daily in mixed-age groups. This develops social calibration, risk assessment, and emotional regulation. The modern school + screen replacement has removed the training ground the brain requires.

Video 10 — 'Your Sugar Craving Is 3 Million Years Old'

PILLAR 1**TARGET KEYWORD** why do we crave sugar / sugar addiction brain science**HOOK** The reason you cannot say no to sugar is not lack of willpower. It is 3 million years of evolution screaming at you to eat the fruit before the other ape does.

Core science: Sugar scarcity in the ancestral environment made caloric surplus a survival imperative. The reward system was calibrated for rare, high-value nutritional events. Food

companies discovered this in the 1980s (Howard Moskowitz / Bliss Point). They created infinite sugar with zero satiation signal. The mismatch is total.

SECTION 12 — ASSET PASTE SECTION

This section is reserved for pasting visual assets, screenshots, and reference material as you gather them. Each slot is labeled for what should go there.

12.1 Competitor Channel Screenshots

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

Zenn — Channel Page Screenshot (full page, June 2026) Shows: subscriber count, channel art, featured video, playlist layout

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

Zenn — Top Videos Grid Screenshot Shows: the 9-12 most popular video thumbnails arranged by the channel — study thumbnail patterns

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

Competitor Channel 2 — [Name TBD] Add another channel in adjacent niche (dark psychology, ancestral health, evolutionary psychology)

12.2 Viral Thumbnail Reference Board

Paste 6-12 thumbnail screenshots that represent the visual style you want to achieve or analyze. Label each one.

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

THUMBNAIL REF 1 — [Video Title / Channel] Note what works: text placement, visual split, color scheme, curiosity gap

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

THUMBNAIL REF 2 — [Video Title / Channel]

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

THUMBNAIL REF 3 — [Video Title / Channel]

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

YOUR CHANNEL — Thumbnail Mockup Draft Paste your own first thumbnail concept here for reference

12.3 vidIQ / Analytics Screenshots

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

vidIQ Keyword Research Screenshot — 'evolutionary mismatch' Shows volume, competition, score —
paste whenever you run this search

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

vidIQ Channel Comparison — Zenn vs Your Channel (once launched) Track trajectory comparison over
time

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

YouTube Studio Analytics Screenshot — First 30 Days Paste after first month to document baseline
performance

12.4 Script Drafts Paste Zone

Paste full script drafts for upcoming videos here before they go into production. Keep one script per sub-section.

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

FULL SCRIPT — Video 1: 'Why You Can't Stop Scrolling' Paste complete narration script here with
[BEAT] labels at each section transition

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

FULL SCRIPT — Video 2: 'The Real Reason Modern People Are So Lonely'

12.5 Research Notes Paste Zone

Paste raw research notes, paper abstracts, study summaries here as you collect them.

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

RESEARCH NOTES — [Topic / Paper Title] Paste: key finding, sample size, journal, DOI, how to use in a video

[PASTE SCREENSHOT / ASSET HERE]

RESEARCH NOTES — [Topic / Paper Title]

SECTION 13 — GROWTH MILESTONES & SUCCESS METRICS

13.1 Benchmark Targets

Milestone	Target Timeline
First 100 subs	Week 1-2 (social share of first 2 videos)
First 1,000 subs	Month 1-2 (YPP eligibility begins)
First viral video (100K+ views)	Month 2-4 (algorithm picks up a Pillar 1 video)
10K subs	Month 3-5 (consistent weekly posting + Shorts)
YPP (4K watch hours + 1K subs)	Month 2-3 (documentaries retain well)
First brand deal inquiry	Month 4-6 (wellness brands scout at 10-20K)
50K subs	Month 6-9 (first major compound effect from series)
100K subs + Silver Play Button	Month 10-18 (if consistency holds)

13.2 Weekly KPIs to Track

- Click-Through Rate (CTR): Target above 6% for long-form. Below 4% = thumbnail needs rework.
- Average View Duration (AVD): Target above 50% for 8-10 min videos. Below 40% = hook or pacing needs fix.
- Impressions to Subscribers ratio: 1-3% is healthy. Below 0.5% = content not converting new viewers.
- Short-to-Long crossover: % of Shorts viewers who then watch a long-form video. Target 5%+.
- Subscriber velocity: Week-over-week growth trend. Any plateau for 3+ weeks = content angle needs adjustment.

13.3 Notes & Running Log

Use this section to document decisions, pivots, ideas, and learnings as the channel grows.

